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FAOSTYLE

English

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CONTENTS

1 _ ABOUT FAOSTYLE 8

2 _ BUILDING A PUBLICATION 9

2.1 PARTS OF A PUBLICATION 9

2.1.1 Front cover 9

2.1.2 Inside front cover (and inside back cover) 10

2.1.3 Front matter (preliminary pages) 10

2.1.4 Main text 14

2.1.5 End matter 14

2.1.6 Back cover 15

2.2 FORMATTING 16

2.2.1 Page numbering 16

2.2.2 Running heads or feet 16

2.2.3 Headings 16

2.2.4 Notes (general) 16

2.2.5 Figures, tables and boxes 16

2.2.6 Photographs and illustrations 18

2.2.7 Contact information 18

2.3 AUTHORSHIP, EDITORSHIP AND REQUIRED CITATION 19

2.3.1 Corporate author 19

2.3.2 Individual author(s) or editor(s) 19

2.3.3 Required citation 20

3 _ WRITING WELL 21

3.1 GENERAL PRINCIPLES OF WRITING 21

3.2 COMMON MISTAKES 21

3.3 NON-DISCRIMINATORY LANGUAGE 22

3.3.1 Indigenous Peoples 22

3.3.2 Gender-neutral and gender-sensitive language 22

3.3.3 Age 23

3.3.4 Cultural and ethnic diversity 23

3.3.5 Disability 23
3.4 WRITING A BLURB 24
3.5 WRITING A TITLE 25
3.5.1 Writing a title for a figure, table or box 25
3.5.2 Series titles 25
4 _ SPELLING 27
5 _ PUNCTUATION 28
5.1 APOSTROPHES 28
5.2 BRACKETS AND PARENTHESES 28
5.3 COLONS 28
5.4 COMMAS 28
5.5 ELLIPSES 29
5.6 EN-DASHES 29
5.7 FULL STOPS 29
5.8 HYPHENS 30
5.9 LISTS 31
5.9.1 Unordered lists 31
5.9.2 Numbered lists 32
5.10 QUOTATION MARKS 32
5.11 SEMICOLONS 32
5.12 SLASHES 33
5.13 SPACES 33
6 _ TERMINOLOGY AND NAMES 34
6.1 FAO-RELATED TERMINOLOGY 34
6.2 SDG-RELATED TERMINOLOGY 35
6.3 NAMES 35
6.3.1 Country names and regions 35
6.3.2 Titles and proper names 37
6.3.3 Scientific names 38
6.4 FOREIGN LANGUAGES 38

7 _ ABBREVIATIONS 39

8 _ CAPITALIZATION 41

8.1 TITLES AND HEADINGS 42

8.2 REGIONS AND GROUPS OF PEOPLE 42

9 _ ITALICS, BOLD AND UNDERLINING 43

9.1 ITALICS 43

9.2 BOLD 43

9.3 UNDERLINING 43

10 _ NUMBERS 44

10.1 UNITS 45

10.2 PERCENTAGES 46

10.3 DATES 46

10.4 TIME 47

10.5 CURRENCIES 47

10.6 MATHEMATICS AND EQUATIONS 47

11 _ NOTATION (inserting endnotes and footnotes) 48

11.1 FORMATTING 48

11.2 ENDNOTES 49

11.3 FOOTNOTES 49

11.3.1 Footnotes in front matter, main text and end matter 49

11.3.2 Footnotes in figures, tables and boxes 49

11.4 DOWNLOAD NOTES 50

12 _ REFERENCING AND CREDITING SOURCES 51

12.1 ARTWORK, PHOTOGRAPHS AND OTHER IMAGES 51

12.2 REFERENCING IN FRONT MATTER (PRELIMINARY PAGES) 52

12.3 REFERENCING IN MAIN TEXT AND END MATTER 52

12.3.1 Author–date system (in-text) 52

12.3.2 Endnote system (in-text) 53

12.3.3 Direct quotes (both systems) 53
12.4 REFERENCING IN FIGURES, TABLES AND BOXES 54
12.5 BIBLIOGRAPHIC INFORMATION 54
12.5.1 Author–date (References) 55
12.5.2 Endnotes (Notes) 55
12.6 WRITING OR GENERATING BIBLIOGRAPHIC LISTS 56
12.7 FORMATTING CITATIONS AND BIBLIOGRAPHIC LISTS 57
12.7.1 Manual formatting 57
12.7.2 Automatic formatting 57
12.8 EXAMPLES OF BIBLIOGRAPHIC STYLE 58
12.8.1 Sample references 59
Appendix 1 ONLINE EDITORIAL RESOURCES 65
Appendix 2 LIST OF RECOMMENDED WORDS 67
A 67
B 69
C 71
D 75
E 77
F 78
G 81
H 82
I 84
J 85
K 85
L 85
M 87
N 89
O 90
P 91
Q 94

R 94
S 95
T 99
U 101
V 101
W 102
Y 104
Z 104

Appendix 3 USEFUL SHORTCUTS AND FUNCTIONS IN MICROSOFT WORD 105

Appendix 4 INSTALLING AND USING ZOTERO 106

A4.1 Installation 106
A4.2 Legal sources 107
A4.3 Database sources 108

NOTES 109

1 _ ABOUT FAOSTYLE

What we refer to as “FAOSTYLE” is FAO's house style. It should be applied to all FAO knowledge products to ensure clarity and consistency. We also recommend applying FAOSTYLE to web content. The guide is a living document and updated regularly. A list of corrections, revisions and updates is available here.

All FAO staff, consultants and contractors involved in writing, reviewing, editing, translating or proofreading FAO knowledge products in English should refer to “FAOSTYLE: English”.

This guide is also available in Arabic, Chinese, French, Spanish and Russian.

For editorial issues not addressed in “FAOSTYLE: English”, please refer to Appendix 1 Online editorial resources. For further information on copyright, content development, marketing, and other publishing matters, please refer to other guidelines published by OCCP.

Note that some of the resources referred to throughout this document are internal. If you are an external collaborator and require access to any of these resources, please ask your supervisor.

2 _ BUILDING A PUBLICATION

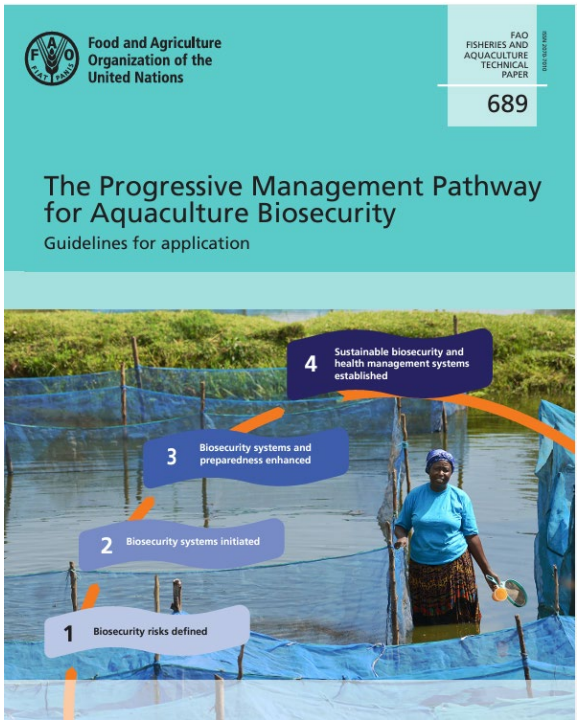
Below is a suggested order of common parts of a standard publication (such as a book or a report). The list is not exhaustive, as some publications may have other parts not included here. This guidance applies to all publications, regardless of their format. FAO produces digital formats (EPUB, MOBI, HTML and web PDF) and print PDFs.

2.1 PARTS OF A PUBLICATION

2.1.1 Front cover

Include full title and – if applicable – subtitle, series title, series number and ISSN. Authors and editors must not be named on the cover. Any other text, such as a tagline for a project, must be approved in advance by OCCP.

Figure 2.1 _ Example of an FAO publication with a title, subtitle, series title, issue number and ISSN



Note: The required citation for this publication is: *FAO*. 2023. *The Progressive Management Pathway for Aquaculture Biosecurity – Guidelines for application*. FAO Fisheries and Aquaculture Technical Paper, No. 689. Rome. https://doi.org/10.4060/cc6858en

The front cover of a magazine may include features, synopses, highlights and the like.

Not all publications have covers. When a product is designed without a cover, the first page includes the same information a cover would include but may also list authors, if applicable, and photo credits for images on that page. The main text will start on this page.

2.1.2 Inside front cover (and inside back cover)

Where the inside front and back covers of a print PDF are blank and are not included in the page count of the publication, it is possible to remove them from a digital format.

However, where the inside front or back covers are not blank, or where they have been included in the page count, it is not possible to remove them from a digital format.

2.1.3 Front matter (preliminary pages)

Front matter refers to content that comes before the main text. For numbering of front matter, see 2.2.1 Page numbering.

2.1.3.1 Title page

All publication formats except HTML may have a title page. The title page includes the full title and – if applicable – subtitle, series title and series number. This is followed by – if permitted – authors or editors (with their affiliations, if applicable). Any publishers are named in full (no abbreviations), along with the city and year of publication, in the footer. No additional text may be added to the title page. In HTML publications, authors are named under the title.

2.1.3.2 Copyright page

This page is required for certain knowledge products, based on the quality control criteria outlined in the FAO Publications Taxonomy. During quality control, OCCP will confirm whether the copyright page is required and provide corrections or additional details as needed.

Publications in non-FAO languages use the English disclaimer page and Creative Commons licence unless one of the other FAO languages is better suited. The exceptions to this are Italian and Portuguese.

Templates in the six FAO languages, as well as Italian and Portuguese, can be downloaded here.

For a co-publication, a customized copyright page will be included, in English, within the co-publishing agreement. This page should be inserted, unchanged, into the publication. It is the authoring unit's responsibility to have the copyright page translated, if needed, into FAO's other languages. See 2.5 Copyright, co-publishing and Open Access in the "Publishing policy" for information about co-publishing agreements.

The author disclaimer[a] should be omitted from the copyright page if FAO is named as the, or one of the, corporate authors. The FAO Publications Taxonomy defines which publication content categories can have individual authors and which have corporate authorship.

If maps with dotted or dashed administrative boundaries are included in the publication, a specific disclaimer sentence[b] is added within the general disclaimer.

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[a] Author disclaimer: The views expressed in this information product are those of the author(s) and do not necessarily reflect the views or policies of FAO. Language versions are available within the corresponding language template for the copyright page.

[b] Map disclaimer: Dashed lines on maps represent approximate border lines for which there may not yet be full agreement. Review the map guidance document for instructions on placement and for language versions.

The copyright page typically follows the title page but may be placed elsewhere for certain types of publications, such as immediately after the front cover in a report.

In HTML publications, a link to the copyright section, named Citation and copyright (where there is a required citation) or Copyright (where no citation is required) is placed in the footer. The main navigation of the publication will also link to the content.

Box 2.1 _ Required citation

To write a required citation, combine the following elements with a full stop after each, unless otherwise instructed:

AUTHOR(S) – Individuals' names are generally written Pavarotti, L. Separate multiple author names with commas and the last two names with and or & (no comma). If there are editors instead of authors, insert a comma after the final name and add ed. or eds. Many FAO publications are given corporate authorship: FAO. More guidance on authorship is available in 2.3 Authorship, editorship and required citation and in the Authorship and plagiarism guidelines.

YEAR – The year of publication.

TITLE – Insert the complete title in italics and using sentence case. To separate the title from the subtitle, use:

- a full stop for Arabic;
- a Chinese dash (—) for Chinese;
- an en-dash (–) for English;
- a full stop or colon for French;
- a colon for Spanish; and
- a full stop for Russian.

EDITION or **REVISION** (when applicable) – Insert the edition or revision, or both, in sentence case, e.g. Second edition or Revised.

SERIES TITLE and **ISSUE NUMBER** (when applicable) – Insert the series title using initial capitalization. If there is an issue number, add a comma and insert the number, e.g. FAO Fisheries and Aquaculture Technical Papers, No. 693. If the series number is a date, omit No.

PLACE(S) OF PUBLICATION – The city (or cities) of publication. If it is not a capital city, add a comma and the country (use the Short Name from NOCS; see 6.3.1 Country names and regions for some exceptions).

PUBLISHER(S) – Add the publisher(s) only if different from the author(s). Use a comma (not a full stop) to separate the place of publication and the publisher. Insert commas between each publisher and separate the last two with and or & (no comma), e.g. CAIRO, FAO, CIRAD & CIHEAM. If co-publishers are publishing in different cities, indicate each location. The location should precede each publisher (e.g. Rome, FAO & Washington, DC, World Bank).

Box 2.1 _ Required citation

DOI – When supplied by OCCP, insert the full DOI URL. Do not use a full stop at the end.

Examples of correct citations:

FAO & WHO. 2022. *Code of Practice for the Prevention and Reduction of Lead Contamination in Foods.* Codex Code of Practice, No. CXC 56-2004. Rome. https://doi.org/10.4060/cc0579en

Kenney, N. 2022. *Achieving de facto gender equality in land, forest and fisheries tenure – Scaling up the adoption of temporary special measures in national legal frameworks.* FAO Legal Papers, No. 110. Rome, FAO. https://doi.org/10.4060/cb9701en

The credit for a front or back cover photograph or illustration, or for the hero image of an HTML publication, may be placed at the bottom of the copyright page of a PDF; on the back cover if there is one; on one of the inside covers, if applicable; or at the bottom of the hero image in HTML publications. See 2.2.6 Photographs and illustrations for how to credit a photograph.

A QR code related to the publication may be inserted on the copyright page. QR codes are issued by OCCP upon request.

2.1.3.3 Abstract

The abstract (usually 150–200 words and maximum 400 words) is a summary of the publication, designed to help readers quickly understand the main subject and objectives.

An abstract should include the following information:

- main subject of the publication;
- methods used to compile the content (research, case studies, fieldwork, external collaborations, etc.);
- results or findings;
- main audience; and
- main conclusions and recommendations.

2.1.3.4 Contents

A table of contents, titled Contents, includes each section of the front matter (except the title page, the copyright page and the table of contents itself); the titles of the first-level headings, such as chapter titles; any second-level (subsection) titles; and each section of the end matter.

The table of contents may contain a subsection that includes all figures, tables and boxes. This is required when there are many stand-alone elements, and suggested if it would be particularly useful for the reader to have quick access. If it benefits the reader, it may be separated into three subsections: Figures, Tables and Boxes. Avoid repeating, for example, Figure 1, Figure 2, etc., in such subsections; instead, each entry should contain only the number and title, e.g.:

Figures

1. Distribution of households by income in Nicaragua, 1999–2019
2. Distribution of female-headed households by income in Guatemala, 1999–2019

In HTML publications, the table of contents appears as the menu. The list of figures, tables and boxes can be linked to from the footer, in addition to being available via the main navigation.

2.1.3.5 Contributors

A contributors section may only be included in certain cases; see the Authorship and plagiarism guidelines for details. The guidelines state which contributors may be included in this section and how to correctly credit them. This section may be substituted with a masthead when publishing a magazine or journal.

In HTML publications, a link to the contributors, if applicable, should be placed in the footer.

2.1.3.6 Acknowledgements

This section should be brief, acknowledging organizations and individuals that have made a significant contribution to the preparation and production of the publication but do not appear in the contributors section. Refer to the Authorship and plagiarism guidelines to identify when someone should be recognized as an author and not just acknowledged. Acknowledgements may appear on the same page as contributors.

In HTML publications, a link to the acknowledgements should be placed in the footer (Contributors and Acknowledgements is also acceptable as a single section heading).

2.1.3.7 Foreword

A foreword is a short introduction to a book, usually written by a person who did not contribute to the content of the main text. It highlights the assets of the publication, underscores its added value, and presents it to its target audience. A foreword is always signed and is used in flagship, general interest and high-profile publications.

In HTML publications, a link to the foreword, if applicable, should be placed underneath the hero image.

2.1.3.8 Preface

A preface introduces a publication, stating its subject, scope and aims. It describes how the idea for the book was developed, mentions any previous editions, and identifies the target audience. The preface is usually written by the author(s) or, for publications with corporate authorship, by the main contributor(s) of the work. This may be substituted with an editorial or letter from the editor when publishing a journal or magazine.

In HTML publications, a link to the preface, if applicable, should be placed underneath the hero image.

2.1.3.9 Abbreviations

A list of abbreviations used in the publication, with the full terms written out, can be included as necessary. Do not capitalize terms that are not proper names.

In HTML publications, a link to the abbreviations should be placed in the footer.

2.1.3.10 Executive summary or summary

All publications for which a launch or press release is envisaged must include an executive summary. It is good practice for all other books to include a summary (which is shorter than an executive summary). The goal is to provide a brief overview of the content contained in the publication. Its main audiences are policymakers, decision makers and others who may not have time to read the whole publication but need to access its information rapidly and possibly make decisions based on what they read. An executive summary should be no longer than 10 percent of the whole publication. A good executive summary may lead people to read the rest of the publication.

In HTML publications, a link to the executive summary should be placed underneath the hero image.

2.1.4 Main text

The main text, or body, of a publication can consist of parts, chapters, sections and subsections, or a combination of these. For example, a short publication may be divided into sections only, while a long publication may have multiple sections and subsections.

The first paragraph of a chapter or section, following a title or heading, is not indented. Otherwise, paragraphs should be indented, unless they are separated by ample white space.

2.1.5 End matter

End matter refers to content that comes after the main text.

2.1.5.1 Bibliography

A bibliography is a list of references to all sources cited in the main text and end matter; it does not include personal communications or sources cited in the front matter. The bibliography may include subsections for some or all figures, tables and boxes. Duplication of sources may occur.

The placement of the bibliographic information within the end matter is flexible. For example, where there are no sources cited in annexes or appendices, it is recommended to insert the list ahead of these sections.

When using the author–date system, the bibliography is titled References and is organized alphabetically by author. When using the endnote system, it is titled Notes and each entry is numbered by order of first appearance in the text.

When the author wishes to include sources not directly cited in the text, for the author-date system, the title Bibliography is used in place of References and the list is subdivided into two lists titled References and Further reading (or Additional resources). When using the endnote system, a separate heading for Further reading (or Additional resources) follows Notes. They are alphabetically arranged by author name.

All references in the bibliographic section, whether ordered by number or alphabetically, are formatted in the same way, see 12.8 Examples of bibliographic style for templates.

2.1.5.2 Glossary

A glossary of terms may be required in some publications. Ensure that all entries are correctly attributed and listed alphabetically. If the glossary is necessary for the understanding of the entire publication, it may be moved to the front matter and placed before the executive summary.

2.1.5.3 Appendix or appendices

Appendices are written by the publication's author. They contain stand-alone supplementary information to the publication, and, likewise, the publication can stand alone without them. Numbering of figures, tables and boxes begins anew in each appendix, e.g. Table A1.1 is the first table in Appendix 1.

2.1.5.4 Annex or annexes

Annexes are written by someone other than the author of the text and are self-contained, stand-alone items, such as the text of a law or news article. Figure, table and box numbering begin anew in each annex, such as by adding A before the number, e.g. Figure A1.1. If a publication includes both appendices and annexes that have figures, tables and boxes, find a way to identify them by either continuing the numbering system from appendices to annexes, or by replacing A with B in the annexes.

2.1.5.5 Index

Few FAO publications require an index. Generating a useful index is not an easy task. It requires skill and a clear understanding of the ideas in the publication. An automatically generated index may prove frustrating to users. Ensure that the index is concise by only including entries of significance to the publication.

2.1.6 Back cover

The back cover should include a blurb (about 250–300 words). The blurb is not a summary or abstract – it is a marketing device that includes interesting highlights and facts to attract readers' attention. See more information in 3.4 Writing a blurb. In HTML publications, the blurb appears in a section called About this publication and a link should be placed in the footer.

The back cover may include contact information, non-FAO logos and a QR code. QR codes are issued by OCCP upon request.

The footer is reserved for information provided by OCCP during quality control, such as a barcode or a job number. If a copyright page is not present, the footer may also include:

- the citation (required only if a DOI is assigned);
- the copyright holder and year;
- the Creative Commons licence;
- the general disclaimer; and
- disclaimers for maps, authors or third-party logos.

If there is no back cover, the last page may accommodate the standard back cover content, but space must be reserved for the required footer content from OCCP.

2.2 FORMATTING

2.2.1 Page numbering

Page numbering is required in all formats except HTML publications.

It is best practice to use lowercase roman numerals (i, ii, iii…) for the front matter and arabic numerals (1, 2, 3…) for the rest of the publication, as the front matter is often compiled separately from the main text. However, it is also possible to use arabic numerals consecutively for the entire publication. The title page is usually the first page to be numbered (either i or 1), but neither the title page nor the copyright page display the number. In most books, the table of contents will be on page iii (or 3) and is the first page to display a number. In a print PDF, the odd numbers (i, iii, v, etc. and 1, 3, 5, etc.) should appear on the right side of a two-page spread.

When using roman numerals for the front matter, page numbering in arabic numerals begins with the first page of the main text. Thus, for example, Chapter 1 Introduction is page 1. Page numbering continues from main text into end matter without restarting.

2.2.2 Running heads or feet

Traditionally, running heads put the chapter title on the right-hand pages and the publication title on the left-hand pages. For web PDFs and HTML publications, there may be value in combining the chapter title and publication title on every page. Shorten the titles as necessary.

In the end matter, both running heads may indicate the part of the publication. Alternatively, the part of the publication can be put on the left-hand pages (e.g. Appendices) and the specific section on the right-hand pages (e.g. Appendix 3 List of participants). Avoid running heads and feet in the front matter, unless specific sections running over several pages would benefit from them.

2.2.3 Headings

Use no more than four levels of headings, including the headings for parts and chapters, which should be as concise as possible. Avoid the use of numbered subheadings (e.g. 2.4, 2.4.1) unless necessary for cross-referencing purposes. Ensure that the hierarchy of headings is clear in the design of your document (for example, by formatting the headings in Microsoft Word).

2.2.4 Notes (general)

See 11 Notation (inserting endnotes and footnotes) for information on footnotes and endnotes and how to format them.

Keep footnotes short to minimize layout problems.

2.2.5 Figures, tables and boxes

Figures, tables and boxes should complement, not repeat, the main text. They can also help break up the text, although too many placed consecutively may disrupt the reading experience.

They should be numbered consecutively throughout the main text, e.g. Table 1, Table 2, Box 1, Box 2 (numbering restarts in appendices and annexes). More sophisticated numbering may be required for lengthier or multi-authored works. For example, where necessary, the numbering may be arranged by chapter (e.g. for Chapter 9, Figure 9.1, Figure 9.2), depending on the nature and purpose of the work.

Titles are placed above tables and boxes. For figures, titles are placed above, unless it is more useful to place the title below – as with scientific publications – as long as it's consistent. Notes and captions are placed below the element.

2.2.5.1 Figures and tables

Some data are better presented in the form of figures or tables rather than text. Figures and tables should reinforce the message of the publication visually.

All data in a figure or table must be cited. See 11 Notation (inserting endnotes and footnotes) and 12 Referencing and crediting sources for more information.

Figures may include graphs, maps, photographs or illustrations that are informative rather than decorative (e.g. a scientific drawing of the life cycle of a pest, or a photo to identify characteristics of a fish).

Keep in mind:

- Each figure or table must address a specific subject. Avoid conflating multiple subjects within one figure or table. If using multiple graphs within a figure, ensure they compare like data.
- Axes, heading rows and legends should be labelled consistently, using sentence case or all-caps, and include relevant units.
- Refer to all figures and tables in the main text (e.g. see Figure 1). Do not use abbreviations (e.g. Fig. 4, Tab. 6). Avoid vague references such as see the table above or refer to the figure below.
- Figures and tables may be separate graphic files, not imported into the Microsoft Word file. Indicate their placement in the Microsoft Word file (close to the first reference to the figure or table). Always provide the designer with the source files (e.g. Microsoft Excel for charts and graphs, or vector format) and always use standard table or spreadsheet software (such as Microsoft Excel) for tables. Otherwise, you risk wasting time and money having them re-created.
- In line with FAO's forthcoming guidelines on accessible publications, alternative text must be created for every figure and table to facilitate accessibility.

For tables only:

- Ensure blank cells are not ambiguous. Prefer an en-dash or abbreviations such as n/a (not applicable or not available; specify which in the notes) or n.s. (not significant).
- Columns of numbers should align neatly, particularly when there are decimal points.
- When the last row or column contains a number that is the sum of other cells, or when there is a chart with percentages, the total sum must be checked for correctness.

2.2.5.2 Boxes

Boxes support and reinforce the main message of the publication; they do not make the primary argument of the text. Boxes are often case studies, first-hand accounts, opposing perspectives or interesting anecdotal stories: in other words, isolated texts that each have a clear narrative structure. Explain any concepts used in boxes within the box; abbreviations should be written out at first mention. See 11 Notation (inserting endnotes and footnotes) and 12 Referencing and crediting sources for information on citing sources indicated in a box.

2.2.6 Photographs and illustrations

Captions should be brief and explanatory. If relevant, they should mention the country (use the NOCS Short Name) and project. Photos must carry a credit line. See 12 Referencing and crediting sources for more information.

In line with FAO's forthcoming guidelines on accessible publications, alternative text must be created for every photograph and illustration to facilitate accessibility.

2.2.7 Contact information

Contact information is strongly recommended but not required and may only be placed on the back cover, or in the footer of the last page if there is no back cover. In an HTML publication, it is placed in the footer. It is written in the language of the publication.

It is best practice to use the full "block". However, on communications materials and short publications without a back cover, the full block may be replaced by a website or email address.

The order of standard elements, layout and formatting are as follows for the full block:

> Division – Stream [OR Office or Centre]
> Generic email address
> Website
> Social media links
> **Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations**
> City, Country

Use the current division and stream or the full office or centre name (see the FAO organizational chart for exact wording). Omit abbreviations and the word stream. Teams and Programme Priority Areas should not be included, but international years and statutory bodies may, provided they are written out in full and include the responsible administrative body, e.g. International Year of Fruits and Vegetables 2021 Secretariat.

The email address, website and social media links are optional.

A generic email address refers to the address for an office, division or senior manager's office. Exceptions can be made for other, non-personal addresses, if there is a cogent argument for their relevance. No unofficial email addresses, nor email addresses containing a person's name, may be used.

The website URL can be shortened to omit http://, https:// and www. Phone numbers should be avoided.

It is possible to use the full mailing address in place of the city and country.

Example 1: For an office

FAO Regional Office for Africa
fao.org/africa
Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations
Accra, Ghana

Example 2: For a division

Resource Mobilization and Private Sector Partnerships – Partnerships and Outreach
PSR-Director@fao.org
fao.org/partnerships/resource-partners
Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations
Rome, Italy

Example 3: For multiple contacts within FAO (can be stacked or put into two columns)

FAO Representation in Haiti
FAO-HT@fao.org
fao.org/haiti
@FAOHaiti
Port-au-Prince, Haiti

Office of Emergencies and Resilience
Data-in- emergencies@fao.org
data-in-emergencies.fao.org
@FAOEmergencies
Rome, Italy

Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations

2.3 AUTHORSHIP, EDITORSHIP AND REQUIRED CITATION

For detailed guidance on authorship, please refer to the Authorship and plagiarism guidelines.

2.3.1 Corporate author

The FAO Publications Taxonomy defines the publications that must have corporate authorship and those that may have individual authors. Publications that must be attributed to FAO are:

- flagship reports and other corporate publications (those that express the official position of FAO or key messages on specific subjects);
- formal publications such as meeting reports, proceedings or circulars;
- advocacy and promotional material such as brochures or flyers;
- certain publications produced under a letter of agreement; and
- general interest books.

2.3.2 Individual author(s) or editor(s)

For publications that may have individual authors (or editors, for edited volumes), as defined by the FAO Publications Taxonomy, there is no limit to the number of authors or editors. Only contributors who meet all four criteria for authorship as described in the Authorship and plagiarism guidelines may be named in the citation and title page. The order of names, agreed upon by all authors or editors in advance, should be based on magnitude of contribution, regardless of professional ranking or management hierarchy.

Names of authors are never displayed on a cover. For publications with a title page, the names of the authors must be inserted on the title page, below the title and above the publishers. For publications with no cover, the authors should be named below the title and banner at the top of the first page.

Author affiliations are accepted only when authors are not FAO-affiliated. The city is only permitted when it is not part of the organization name. Departments and divisions are not permitted. If an author does not have an institutional affiliation, it is acceptable to use international consultant.

2.3.3 Required citation

When a copyright page is present, the required citation goes at the top of that page. If there is no copyright page, the required citation goes in the footer of the final page of the publication. When authors are named in the citation, the standard author disclaimer must appear on the copyright page or in the footer of the final page.

OCCP will approve the citation during quality control. See 2.1.3.2 Copyright page for instructions on building a citation.

3 _ WRITING WELL

3.1 GENERAL PRINCIPLES OF WRITING

Read your text aloud. If you run out of breath or stumble over a sentence, it is probably too long or complex. You can check the readability of your text using the Flesch Reading Ease and Flesch–Kincaid Grade Level tools available in Microsoft Word.

Remember that the introduction, conclusion and summary may be the only sections that your audience reads in full. Take special care to ensure that these are well written and succinct.

Use plain language and a clear style, avoiding ambiguity:

- Opt for shorter, simpler words rather than long phrases, e.g. because instead of due to the fact that, or needs instead of has a requirement for.
- Beware of buzzwords (e.g. synergy, visioning), as these may quickly fade from usage.
- Avoid jargon, colloquialisms or slang; where necessary, explain the meaning.
- Avoid unnecessary and vague adverbs and intensifiers (e.g. hopefully, really, very).
- Prefer the active to the passive voice, e.g. The company designed the product to appeal to young people rather than The product was designed to appeal to young people.
- Avoid double negatives: It is common to … is better than It is not uncommon to ….
- Use terminology accurately and consistently. Editors of multi-author books should ensure that chapters by different authors employ the same terms for the same concepts.
- Replace imprecise verbs (e.g. do, make, get, enhance) with more precise alternatives (e.g. perform, create, obtain, improve).
- When describing quantities, avoid a few, some, many, enough, several and a number of as these provide no useful information.

3.2 COMMON MISTAKES

- Take care when using collective nouns (e.g. government is). Use the plural form of the verb for people, staff and the police, e.g. The staff **have** received a memorandum. Key exceptions, such as team, can be singular or plural depending on whether the context is emphasizing the group or its members.
- Examples introduced by such as, for example or including should not be followed by etc. These terms imply that the subsequent examples are not an exhaustive list.

TABLE 3.1 _ Common mistakes

Instead of	Use
different than or different to	different from
participate at	participate in
less	fewer (when referring to quantifiable units, e.g. fewer students, fewer days of sunshine)
with regards to	with regard to (or regarding, in regard to or as regards

3.3 NON-DISCRIMINATORY LANGUAGE

As a UN agency, all of FAO's communications and publications must be guided by a principle of neutrality when serving its Members.

FAO communications must be free of discriminatory language regarding age, gender, gender identity, Indigenous Peoples, migrants, people with disabilities, race, religion and sexual orientation.

3.3.1 Indigenous Peoples

The term Indigenous Peoples (always plural, with both words capitalized) has been agreed upon internationally and at the UN to represent the richness and variety of Indigenous Peoples across the world and their status as rights holders. Avoid referring to Indigenous Peoples as farmers, ethnic groups, local communities or marginalized communities, which are inaccurate. Terms like bands, pueblos or tribes may be appropriate, but only in specific contexts, and Indigenous women and Indigenous youth are broadly accepted. See the FAO Term Portal and AGROVOC for additional terminology.

3.3.2 Gender-neutral and gender-sensitive language

FAO is committed to achieving gender equality in its work. This includes the use of language that is inclusive; reflects a belief in equality between people regardless of their gender; and does not reinforce gender-based stereotypes or discriminatory attitudes, perceptions or behaviours.

To avoid unintentionally implying that only men are being referred to, use forms of address and pronouns that are consistent with gender identity. The construction he or she may be used sparingly but avoid he/she or s/he. Try to rephrase text to avoid the frequent use of gendered pronouns. When it is unclear which pronoun a person has chosen, use they, them and their instead of s/he, him/her and his or her or rephrase to avoid pronouns altogether.

Gender-neutral language is language that does not refer to gender when describing people.

TABLE 3.2 _ Gender-neutral alternatives to commonly used nouns

Instead of	Use
Chairman/woman	Chair, head
Layman	Layperson
Man (v.)	Operate, staff, work at
Man-hour	Work-hour, hour of labour
Mankind	Humanity, human race
Man-made	Artificial, manufactured, synthetic
Manning	Staffing
Manpower	Human resources, labour force, personnel, workers, workforce

Gender-sensitive language refers to the use of terms that are inclusive and avoid reinforcing gender stereotypes. For example, a reference to a farmer's wife implies that the woman has no role in farming. If it is known, the woman should be described beyond her role in relation to her spouse.

3.3.3 Age

Being old is sometimes unfairly equated with undesirable attributes, such as dependence, rigidity of thought or the inability to learn new things. The elderly is no longer considered an acceptable term, whereas terms such as pensioners and senior citizens may be accepted by some but not by others. Older people is generally accepted by all. Where possible, refer to a specific age, e.g. People over the age of 60 ….

3.3.4 Cultural and ethnic diversity

The two most common forms of cultural or ethnic bias are omission and stereotyping.

Omission involves the inclusion of certain points of view or experiences and the exclusion of others, which can greatly influence the reader. Stereotyping is the negative portrayal of members of minority groups. Even seemingly positive or benign ethnic characterizations that reinforce stereotypes are misleading.

Avoid phrases that express a particular ethnocentric perspective.

3.3.5 Disability

When discussing people with disabilities, there are several categories of discrimination:

- People are not defined by a disability; therefore, avoid *marginalizing* language such as epileptics, the blind, the deaf. Instead use people with epilepsy, blind people, deaf people.
- Do not *patronize* by implying that a disability has made someone unfortunate or a victim. A person may use a wheelchair, they are not confined to a wheelchair.

- Language can perpetuate *stigma* around disabilities. Avoid schizophrenic or addict; instead, use person with schizophrenia or person with addiction.
- Avoid *condescending* euphemisms such as differently abled, challenged, handi-capable and special, which mask the reality of disability, and instead use people with disabilities or disabled.
- Do not *medicalize* a person who is disabled, has an impairment or a medical condition by implying they are sick. People with disabilities are patients only in the context of medical care.
- Mention a person's disability only when relevant to the context, rather than *stereotyping* them as heroic or an inspiration for having defied a disability to experience success.

For further information, refer to the UN Disability-Inclusive Communications Guidelines.

3.4 WRITING A BLURB

A blurb is a short text that aims to attract the potential reader's attention and make the reader curious to learn more. It is used on the back cover, on the preview page of the FAO Knowledge Repository, and for other marketing purposes.

OCCP recommends creating a single blurb, called a "multipurpose blurb," that can be adapted for different purposes, depending on medium, audience and space available. Follow this structure:

- It should be 250–300 words total, divided into three paragraphs of 50–100 words.
- The first one or two sentences (maximum 30 words) contain the essence of the publication; this is useful for newsletters or on the web.
- The first paragraph presents the main focus and selling points of the publication and should be able to stand alone, e.g. for use in the publications catalogue. Keep sentences short and easy to scan.
- The second paragraph gives complementary information, such as broader context, secondary themes and more detail. The first two paragraphs together can be used for some marketing materials or the web.
- The third paragraph expands further on the topic, providing background, recommendations or perspectives. The three paragraphs together can be used on the book's back cover and the FAO Knowledge Repository preview page.

For a well-written blurb, follow these guidelines:

- Use strong opening and closing sentences.
- Include striking statistics related to the issue the work is addressing. (Note that new data or sensitive information must not be publicly disclosed before the launch date of a publication under embargo.)
- Highlight the unique aspects of the work, such as recent data and analysis.
- Ensure the blurb has a strong logical and narrative flow.
- Write in a clear style appropriate to the readership of the publication.
- Avoid overuse of technical terms.
- Include relevant keywords as part of the text to strengthen online discoverability.

3.5 WRITING A TITLE

The title of your publication should be accurate, catchy and short. Your title needs to attract your target audience.

Include key ideas in the first ten words as this is what will appear in search engine results. Avoid abbreviations (with the exceptions of FAO and COVID-19).

Future translations should be considered when writing a title: keep in mind that some languages require more words to express the same idea.

Do not add punctuation to separate a title and subtitle on the cover, title page or first page; visually separate them using line breaks or different typefaces. For the required citation, any references to the title in the text, and for running heads or feet, use the following punctuation:

- Set off dates or locations that are part of a title (or part of a subtitle) using a comma.
- Where it is necessary to have multiple phrases *within* a title or *within* a subtitle, separate them with a colon, e.g. *Trees, forests and land use in drylands: a study in six African countries – First annual assessment, 2024*. The first word following the colon may be lower case or capitalized.
- Separate a title from a subtitle using an en-dash, e.g. *Unemployment in rural areas – A study in six African countries*.
- The content type may be included as the subtitle, but not as the main title, e.g. *Mainstreaming small-scale fisheries into climate action for sustainable development in Namibia – Policy brief*.

3.5.1 Writing a title for a figure, table or box

Titles of figures, tables and boxes should be written in clear language that can be understood by a wide audience and outside the context of the publication. Where possible, identify the geographic area and time period covered.

Do not use a full stop at the end of the title. If necessary, add further explanation as a note below the element. When two or more figures or tables are related, the titles should be consistent, e.g.:

Figure 1 Distribution of households by income in Nicaragua, 1999–2019

Figure 2 Distribution of female-headed households by income in Guatemala, 1999–2019

Unless constrained by space, use the full word (percentage, tonnes) in the titles of figures and tables instead of abbreviations. Ensure consistency throughout the publication. For names of countries, use the Short Name for Lists and Tables in NOCS.

3.5.2 Series titles

A series title must be clear, consistent, concise and unique. Avoid abbreviations and words indicating frequency of publication. Series titles must not refer specifically to units, offices or divisions.

Capitalize the first word, the final word and major words in series titles. If the series title includes the publication type, it should be written in plural, such as Manuals, Standards or Working Papers, and be part of the title without any punctuation, e.g. FAO Animal Production and Health Manuals.

The title should use legible and unambiguous typography and appear in the same place on the cover and the title page. In the citation, the series title appears exactly as it does on the cover and title page of the publication.

4 _ SPELLING

FAO applies the following spelling rules:

- words ending in -re/-er
  prefer -re: centre, calibre, theatre
- words ending in -our/-or
  prefer -our: colour, labour, behaviour
- words ending in -ence/-ense
  prefer -ence (for nouns): defence, offence, licence (but spell the verb to license)
- words ending in -l and followed by a suffix
  prefer -ll (not -l): traveller, counselled, modelling
- words ending in -ize/-ise
  prefer -ize: organize, realize, theorize
- words ending in -yse/-yze
  prefer -yse: analyse, catalyse, paralyse

Exceptions to these rules include:

- words that appear in proper names (e.g. Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development or Center for Global Development); and
- quoted material, which should appear as originally written.

When in doubt about the correct spelling to use, refer to Appendix 2 List of recommended words. This list is not comprehensive, so for words not included, use the first spelling listed in the Oxford English Dictionary (OED).

Aim for consistency. Where alternative spellings and terms are available, ensure that usage is consistent within the same publication.

5 _ PUNCTUATION

5.1 APOSTROPHES

Apostrophes have two functions: to denote possession, e.g. the singular a reader's letter (the letter of a reader) and the plural readers' letters (the letters of more than one reader); and to indicate a contraction, e.g. We're unable to meet the deadline (contraction of We are). In general, minimize the use of contractions.

Note the distinction between it's (contraction of it is) and its (genitive), e.g. It's an important document, but its importance is relative.

Apostrophes are not used when referring to plurals, including numbers and letters, e.g. the 1960s, not the 1960's and straight As, not straight A's.

5.2 BRACKETS AND PARENTHESES

Parentheses are used to include less important text in a sentence or to enclose descriptive information.

When only part of a sentence is enclosed in parentheses, punctuation is placed outside (as in this example). (When a complete sentence is enclosed in parentheses, its punctuation is also enclosed, as in this example.)

Use square brackets within parentheses (like this [not parentheses within parentheses]). Exceptions can be made where there is justification.

In quotations, use square brackets for editorial additions, e.g. [sic] to indicate an error.

5.3 COLONS

A colon may be used to introduce a list, definition, explanation or quotation. It is usually followed by a lower case letter, e.g. The programme draws on a range of materials: handbooks, worksheets, posters, notebooks, videos and games. However, an initial capital letter is used when a colon is followed by a complete sentence, e.g. Land-use planning can be summarized by the following questions: What is the present situation? Is change desirable?

5.4 COMMAS

A comma may separate two independent clauses before a conjunction, e.g. The sector is largely based in the United States of America, **but its reach is global.**

A comma is used after an introductory phrase or word, e.g. **However,** they are under no legal obligation to use the revenue received for environmental protection.

Commas may set off complementary information, e.g. A United Nations Resolution adopted in September 2015, *Transforming our world: The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development*, includes several indicators for Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

Do not use a comma:

- after i.e. or e.g.;
- after such as;
- before an opening parenthesis; or
- before and in short lists, e.g. sheep, goats **and** oxen.

A comma may be used before the final and in a list to avoid ambiguity, e.g. The unit was responsible for overall management, research and development, **and** marketing. It may also be used where a sentence comprises a complex series of phrases, e.g. Ensure that the participants receive the training material in advance, have time to prepare their responses, **and** have access to relevant resources.

5.5 ELLIPSES

When using an ellipsis to indicate an omission in text … do not put spaces between the full stops. There should be a space on either side of the ellipsis unless immediately followed by a punctuation mark. Microsoft Word will format it into a symbol by default, and this default version is correct.

An ellipsis is needed at the end of a quotation if it is a complex statement that does not finish with its original punctuation. A concluding full stop may be added to the ellipsis if appropriate in the context …. An ellipsis is not needed at the start of a quotation or at the end of a short fragment that is in running text. Use an ellipsis if omitting text in the middle of a quote.

5.6 EN-DASHES

- An en-dash (–) is longer than a hyphen (-). FAO does not use the longer em-dash (—).
- Do not use double hyphens (--) to denote an en-dash. See Appendix 3 Useful shortcuts and functions in Microsoft Word.
- En-dashes can be used in pairs – leaving a space on either side – to set off an element that is not part of the main sentence. Ideally, they should not be used more than once per paragraph.
- An en-dash can be used alone to add a phrase elaborating what has gone before – leaving a space on either side.
- When occurring at a line break, keep the en-dash at the end of the line (not at the beginning of the next line).

An unspaced en-dash is used:

- between words of equal weight (**South–South** cooperation, **rice–fish** farming);
- for relationships (**dose–response** curve, **cost–benefit** analysis) when the first part of a compound does not modify the second part;
- for a range of values (pp. **1–20**); and
- for a range of dates (**1987–1993**; **2011–2015**). See also 10.3 Dates.

5.7 FULL STOPS

Use full stops:

- with **a.m.**, **p.m.**, **e.g.** and **i.e.**;
- in shortened forms of words such as **ed.**, **et al.**, **Inc.**, **No.**, **p.**, **pp.** and **vol.**; and

- at the end of bibliographic references and general notes, except those ending with a URL.

Do not use full stops:

- after people's qualifications, e.g. MSc and PhD;
- in initialisms and acronyms, e.g. ILO and AIDS;
- after abbreviations of units of measurement, e.g. 12 kg and 30 m;
- after a heading or the title of a figure, table or box; or
- in contractions where the last letter is the same as that of the original word, e.g. vs (versus) and vols (volumes).

5.8 HYPHENS

Avoid overuse of hyphens. For general usage, consult the hyphenation guide of the Chicago Manual of Style.

Turn off the automatic word-break hyphenation function in Microsoft Word by selecting Layout -> Hyphenation -> None.

Some guidelines:

- Avoid breaking words or hyphenated phrases at the end of a line. If necessary, break them between syllables only. Use a non-breaking space or a non-breaking hyphen to avoid ending a line of text with a hyphen. See Appendix 3 Useful shortcuts and functions in Microsoft Word.
- Use upper case for all major hyphenated words in proper nouns, e.g. European Commission for the Control of **Foot-and-Mouth Disease**.
- Most compound adjectives should be hyphenated when they qualify a noun, e.g. **long-term** planning, but plan for the **long term**; **over-the-counter** medicine, but the medicine was bought **over the counter**.
- No hyphen should be used after an adverb ending in -ly, e.g. a **radically changed** situation.
- Adverbs not ending in -ly are followed by a hyphen when used together with an adjective to modify a noun, e.g. a **well-known** problem, but the problem was well known.
- Use hyphens for clarity when describing ages, amounts or lengths of time. Compare: **15-year-old** fish (fish that are 15 years old) with **15 year-old** fish (15 fish that are all one year old). A **15-kg** bag of wheat, a **3-year** plan.
- Separate a prefix from a date with a hyphen, e.g. **pre-2000**.
- Use hyphens when the modifiers in a list end in the same word, e.g. **The survey covered upper-, middle- and lower-income countries**.
- Do not use hyphens in phrasal verbs, e.g. reserves began to **build up**, but the **build-up** was considerable.

- Words beginning with prefixes are generally written as one word, with the following exceptions:
    - when the meaning can be misinterpreted, e.g. **re-form** (form again), but reform (change to a better state);
    - when the prefix ends and the base word begins with certain vowel combinations, leading to potential confusion, e.g. **pre-eminent**;
    - when the prefixes co-, non-, ex- and self- are used to make a compound, e.g. **co-publisher**, **non-contributory**, **ex-directory**, **self-discipline**; or
    - when the base word is capitalized, is a number, or is an abbreviation, e.g. **pro-European**, **post-1970**, **pre-UCS trial**.

5.9 LISTS

Be consistent throughout the document with list formatting. Always follow the opening sentence or sentence fragment with a colon, and always use:

- the same style of bullet to indicate each item in an unordered vertical list;
- the same number and letter hierarchy for complex lists (avoid mixing numbers and bullets in sublists); and
- consistent punctuation and grammar.

5.9.1 Unordered lists

The following examples may be used as general guidelines for unordered vertical lists. Note that these guidelines apply regardless of whether the introductory part is a full sentence or a sentence fragment.

For lists with very short entries (one or two words), the list items are lower case (except if proper nouns) and no punctuation follows the items.

Available audiovisual equipment includes:

- radios
- televisions
- cameras

For lists with longer, more complex entries, the list items are lower case (except if proper nouns) and end with a semicolon. The penultimate item ends with a semicolon followed by and, and the last item ends with a full stop.

A variety of audiovisual equipment is available to staff members, including:

- radios, for communicating between locations;
- televisions, for screening content; **and**
- cameras, for recording events.

When every item in the list is a complete sentence, all items must be in sentence case and end with a full stop.

Any staff members wishing to borrow audiovisual equipment must follow a set of rules:

- The necessary equipment should be requested from suppliers.
- All staff should provide a budget code for each request.
- Staff should account for any borrowed equipment.

5.9.2 Numbered lists

Use a numbered list when a specific sequence is dictated, to facilitate subsequent cross-referencing, e.g. **see step 12**, or because the preceding text makes specific mention of a ranking or number of entries, e.g. There are **15 reasons** you should offer your support.

5.10 QUOTATION MARKS

Punctuation should be included within the quotation marks "if it is part of the original material!" but if it is not part of the quote, it should be "outside the quote".

"Where the quotation is a grammatically complete sentence, starting with a capital letter, the full stop lies within the closing quotation marks."

Quotation marks should be used only for direct quotes and scare quotes (expressions that are colloquial, ironic or purposely use non-standard language). Scare quotes should be used rarely.

Always use double quotation marks (") rather than single quotation marks (') unless there is a quote within a quote, e.g. Baresi (1998, p. 72) reports that "farmers complain about **'unofficial'** agents."

When a quotation is approximately three lines or longer, indent the quotation and do not use quotation marks.

5.11 SEMICOLONS

Semicolons are used to separate independent clauses that have different subjects and are not connected by a conjunction. A semicolon is followed by an initial lower case letter.

In long sentences comprising a series of complex clauses, at least one of which contains a comma, semicolons may replace commas, e.g. The meeting covered IT, human resources and capacity building; reviewed the minutes of the previous meeting and proposed amendments to the agenda; and explored concerns raised by the participants in relation to the new information-sharing platform and software upgrades.

5.12 SLASHES

The slash / should generally be avoided in running text. When used, there should be no space before or after the slash.

Try to rephrase any sentences that have been written with and/or, as it may cause confusion and difficulty in translation.

Acceptable uses of the slash include:

- to designate mutually exclusive alternatives such as **yes/no** or **pass/fail**, particularly in tables or forms;
- to denote periods such as academic or fiscal years, e.g. the **2008/09** financial year or the Australian summer of **2009/10**; and
- to indicate per between units of measurement and values, e.g. 12 **mg/kg**.

5.13 SPACES

Leave only one space after the full stop between sentences.

Use a non-breaking space between numbers and units; for figure, table and box numbers (e.g. Figure 1); after **e.g.** and **i.e.**; and in other similar cases.

6 _ TERMINOLOGY AND NAMES

The main reference for FAO terminology is the FAO Term Portal, which should be consulted in case of any doubt.

6.1 FAO-RELATED TERMINOLOGY

The full name of FAO is the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations. Note that when indicating the abbreviation, FAO is placed in parentheses at the end of the full name, not after the word Organization.

The abbreviation is FAO, not the FAO and not F.A.O., e.g. In 1951, **FAO** moved its headquarters to Rome. The abbreviation FAO of the UN is tolerated for some media purposes but should generally be avoided. Other common mistakes to avoid are the use of Agricultural or Organisation.

Write **an FAO** regulation (not a FAO regulation).

Following an initial mention, **FAO** may subsequently be referred to as **the Organization**, using an initial capital, e.g. **The Organization** has Regional Offices around the globe. In the same way, the FAO Conference, after it has been mentioned in full, may subsequently be referred to as **the Conference**.

FAO **h**eadquarters does not take a capital h. Do not use the initialism HQ. When referring to FAO's offices, whether in a specific or general context, use initial capitalization:
Country **O**ffices, **D**ecentralized **O**ffices, **L**iaison **O**ffices, **R**egional **O**ffices, **S**ubregional **O**ffices.
Avoid the use of national office.

Hyphens are used in Director-General, Assistant Director-General and Secretary-General.

Correct names for FAO strategies and concepts should follow the FAO Term Portal. For the four betters, always use lower case: better production, better nutrition, a better environment and a better life. Programme Priority Areas (PPAs) should have initial capitalization. The names of the PPAs themselves use sentence case (e.g. Green innovation), except for those that are names of approaches or programmes (e.g. One Health).

FAO has 197 Members, comprising 194 Member Nations, one Member Organization (the European Union) and two Associate Members (the Faroe Islands and Tokelau). According to the FAO Basic texts, it is appropriate to refer to Members or Member Nations. The term Member States is used to refer to the individual states of the Member Organization.[1] Members, Member Nations, Member Organization, Member States and Associate Members should be capitalized when referring to FAO. The Holy See, not the Vatican, has Permanent Observer status at FAO.

6.2 SDG-RELATED TERMINOLOGY

For the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), the following rules apply:

- Be consistent with the use of the short or long form of the SDG name within a document. Refer to the Sustainable Development Goals Helpdesk.
- When using the short form, check initial caps in the FAO Term Portal, e.g. Zero Hunger, Life below Water.
- Use 2030 Agenda, not Agenda 2030 or any other version.
- Use a non-breaking space between SDG and the number, i.e. SDG 1.
- For targets and indicators, use lower case if mentioned generally. When used with a specific number, capitalize and use the following form: Target 1.1, Indicator 17.b.1.
- If space is a concern, the abbreviation SDGs may be used in headings on inside pages (including in running heads), but not on the front cover.

6.3 NAMES

6.3.1 Country names and regions

All FAO content must follow the Names of Countries and Territories (NOCS) database. The designations used in NOCS may differ from popular use. They normally follow United Nations practice, although in two specific cases FAO has adopted a different solution:

- the European Union is treated as a country (because it is an FAO Member) and therefore may not be abbreviated to the EU (some exceptions apply); and
- Palestine is used, rather than the State of Palestine.

The M49 country and area codes are standard use for FAO. In some cases, M49 codes have been adapted to FAO specifics.

Pay attention to sensitive political issues. Include additional statements when required and FAO's standard disclaimers. Maps must be checked carefully. Consult the map guidance folder for source files, guidance and special disclaimers.

For more information, refer to Administrative Circular 2021/13 and the Annex thereto.

6.3.1.1 General guidelines

Keep in mind the following:

- Use the Near East rather than the Middle East unless the latter is specifically required.
- For former administrative areas, use former rather than ex- or other forms, e.g. the former Soviet Union.
- Countries such as the Bahamas and the United States of America are treated as singular nouns, e.g. Maldives is the smallest country in Asia.
- When listing countries, the default order is alphabetical. Depending on the context, territories and states may come at the end of a list.

- Geopolitical names that include common nouns – such as Islands (but not Island), Gulf, Territory, Kingdom, Isle and Republic – should be preceded by the definite article in a sentence, e.g. the Persian Gulf.
- Region names should be preceded by the definite article in a sentence, e.g. the Near East.

Some exceptions:

- The United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland and the United States of America may be shortened to (the) United Kingdom and (the) United States, respectively, in text, figures (except maps), tables and boxes after appearing written out once in full in the main text of the document. This exception does not extend to people's titles or signatures; covers; or title pages.
- The use of UK and USA in lieu of the NOCS Short Name is permitted in citations only.
- US, UK and EU may be used as adjectives, such as **US** exports.
- EU-27 and EU-25 are acceptable if their meaning is clarified, and EU-27 and the United Kingdom may be used after the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland has been written out once.

6.3.1.2 Using NOCS entries

The **Full Name** is reserved for formal documents, e.g. official agreements and formal invitations.

The **Short Name** is used in most text and in titles or headings. Typically, the Short Name is already formatted the way it should be written, e.g. China, Hong Kong SAR. However, when the name has (the) at the end, move it to the front and remove the parentheses, e.g. Niger (the) becomes the Niger.

The article is omitted in the following cases:

- when the country name is the first, or only, word(s) of a title or heading, e.g. *United States of America GLOBEFISH Market Profile*;
- directly after a colon, comma or en-dash in a title or heading, e.g. *National gender profile of agriculture – United Republic of Tanzania*;
- when specifying a location (after a comma) where a meeting or other event took place, e.g. *Report on Port State Measures – Wageningen, Kingdom of the Netherlands*; and
- when identifying a place of publication in a bibliographic reference.

The **Short Name for Lists and Tables** determines the alphabetical order of country names and is used for several specific purposes:

- figures (including maps) and tables;
- vertical and in-text lists that follow a colon or are contained within parentheses, e.g. Data was supplied by the following countries: Bahamas, Bolivia (Plurinational State of) and Chile;
- nameplates; and
- contact information and addresses.

When the **Adjective/Nationality** field is blank, use of with the Short Name, e.g. legislation **of** the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

6.3.1.3 Exceptions to the NOCS rules

Note the following exceptions to the rules mentioned in 6.3.1.2 Using NOCS entries:

- After the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland and the United States of America have been written out once in the main text, they may subsequently be shortened to the United Kingdom and the United States, respectively, and to United Kingdom and United States in figures (except maps) and tables only. This exception does not extend to personal titles, signatures, covers or title pages.
- The use of UK and USA in lieu of the Short Name is permitted in citations only.
- US, UK and EU may be used as adjectives, such as **US** exports.
- EU-27 and EU-25 are acceptable if their meaning is explained.

6.3.2 Titles and proper names

Follow individuals' expressed preference on how to mention their names. In some languages, the surname is the first element; in these cases the order should not be inverted. Note that Spanish and Portuguese names often include two or more surnames.

When referring to an individual, generally use the person's surname only (or given name and surname if there is a justification for both).[a] For Director-General Qu Dongyu, the given name and surname should always be used together. Note that in official documentation (but not in publications), the whole surname should be capitalized: QU.

Only use honorifics or titles, such as Dr and Professor, if strictly relevant to the context. Do not use Mr, Mrs or Ms. Some guidelines for the alphabetization of names (for reference sections and indexes):

- *Chinese and Vietnamese names*: alphabetize according to the first (family) name, e.g. **K**im Thanh, C.
- *Arabic names*: the particles Al and El are not used when alphabetizing reference lists and indexes, e.g. Al-Hamadan is listed under **H** and not under A, so it would be **H**amadan, S.A. Al.
- *Burmese names*: move the honorific (U, Daw, Saw) to the end before alphabetizing, e.g. Aung Sang Suu Kyi, **Daw**.
- *Spanish names*: where there are two surnames, alphabetize according to the first surname, e.g. Alejandra Martinez Espinosa is listed under **M**artinez Espinosa, A.
- *Portuguese names*: where there are two or more surnames, the entry is alphabetized according to the last surname. Words like Filho, Junior, Neto and Sobrinho are treated as part of the last surname: Paulino Ricardo do Rosario Gomes Filho is written as **G**omes Filho, P. R. do Rosario.

[a] Some exceptions are permitted for more informal content, such as magazines or web stories.

- *Particles*: van, von, de, etc. are used for the alphabetical ordering of the list, e.g. **de** María is listed under **D** and not under M. In Dutch, particles are upper case when they start the name, e.g. Van Otterdijk, R.

6.3.3 Scientific names

Use italics (see also 9.1 Italics) to indicate genera, species and subspecies (e.g. ***Oryza sativa***, ***Cucurbita*** spp.), but not for higher levels of taxonomic classification (e.g. Brassicaceae). Note that modifiers to species' names (e.g. var., spp.) and species authorities (e.g. *Rubus* **L.**) are not italicized.

As guidance, the *IPPC style guide* suggests: "Upon first mention of a species, the common name is given first, followed by the scientific name, authority, order and family (e.g. 'Mediterranean fruit fly *Ceratitis capitata* (Wiedemann) (Diptera: Tephritidae)') …. For subsequent mentions, the common name is used."[2] Be consistent throughout the document.

Where scientific names appear as part of italicized titles, they must be presented in roman.

6.4 FOREIGN LANGUAGES

Foreign words and phrases that have been adopted by the English language should not be italicized, e.g. ad hoc, de facto and per capita (see also 9.1 Italics).

Avoid writing a quote or word directly in a foreign language. If it is necessary, provide a translation in parentheses.

Use official translations of titles of publications, major events, organizations and so on. Where no official translation exists, a translation may be made.

When reproducing foreign words, include the diacritical marks that are placed above or beneath certain letters and that change their sound.

Foreign proper nouns, people's names, company names and names of currencies are not italicized. When a foreign organization name is abbreviated and no official translation exists, include a translation after the first mention only in square brackets, if it is necessary for the reader's understanding.

If no official translation of a name exists, transliterate non-Latin scripts into Latin characters. Transliteration tables may be consulted at the Library of Congress website.

Box 6.1 _ For translations

- If a document is bilingual, all the content must be available in both languages; for example, an annex cannot appear in only one of the two languages. An exception may be made for meeting reports that include lengthy lists as annexes. An exception may also be made for the inclusion of a speech at an event. When this is not translated, the following comment must be added as a footnote: This content is available only in the original language of delivery.

7 _ ABBREVIATIONS

There are four types of abbreviations:

- shortened forms of words, for example Vol. for volume;
- contractions, for example Dr for doctor;
- acronyms (initial letters of words pronounced as a word, e.g. NATO); and
- initialisms (initial letters of words pronounced individually, e.g. SMS).

Abbreviations may be used where they improve readability, but do not litter the text with them.

At first mention, the phrase or word should be written out, followed by the abbreviation in parentheses, e.g. the World Health Organization (**WHO**). It may then be used alone, e.g. According to a **WHO** spokesperson….

Abbreviations may be used for complex words or phrases that appear more than three times in one document, such as crop wild relatives (CWR).

An abbreviation may be used without writing out the full phrase at first mention if the abbreviated form is commonly used and readily identifiable (e.g. HIV). Abbreviations should not be used for simple two-word phrases (e.g. PR for public relations). Avoid using abbreviations that are not pre-existing.

Abbreviations are usually defined as singular, so the plural form needs to be marked (SDG, SDGs). If the expression is always used in the plural sense, then the plural may be chosen for the definition of the initialism, e.g. trees outside forests (**TOF**). The preferred option is to define in the singular and aim to use the singular form in text to avoid awkward plural forms.

Where an abbreviation is used for a common noun (as opposed to a proper noun), the expanded form will not usually take initial capitals, hence **g**ross **d**omestic **p**roduct (GDP).

Abbreviations need not be redefined in annexes, appendices, etc. when already correctly abbreviated in the main text of the document (except in boxes, which should be considered separate from the main text). However, if parts of a publication are likely to be read separately (such as the front matter and main text, or independent chapters written by different authors), consider writing out the full phrase or word, and the abbreviation, upon first mention in each of the parts concerned.

Avoid abbreviations that are used only within the Organization, e.g. for divisions, offices and units.

With the exceptions of FAO and COVID-19, avoid using abbreviations in titles and headings of information products. Depending on the target audience, it may be acceptable to use an abbreviation in a title (for example, SDGs in an internal publication).

Avoid beginning sentences with an abbreviation. FAO and COVID-19 are exceptions.

Acronyms and initialisms do not take full stops (e.g. NATO, not N.A.T.O.). Most other abbreviations take full stops at the end (e.g. max.), except for units of measurement (e.g. kg or ml), words where the abbreviation ends with the same letter as the original word (e.g. eds), and contractions (don't). See also 5.7 Full stops.

Avoid overusing the abbreviations e.g., i.e. and etc. in the main text. Where necessary, prefer the use of them in parentheses, not in the main part of the sentence. Usually, these can be replaced with that is, in other words, for example, such as and and so on, if needed at all. An exception may be made for manuals.

When abbreviating the word number, use the abbreviation No.

Avoid the use of abbreviations such as *op. cit.*, *loc. cit.*, *ibid.* and *cf.* in footnotes or endnotes.

If you use numerous abbreviations, list them in alphabetical order in a separate section (Abbreviations) in the front matter. In the list, abbreviations should follow the same capitalization used in the text.

8 _ CAPITALIZATION

It is not usually necessary to capitalize common nouns. For example, rather than the Committees and the Working Groups, write the committees and the working groups. Terminology must be consistent with the FAO Term Portal. Prioritize uncapitalized terms over versions with initial capitalization.

Do not capitalize the phrases arabic numerals, roman type or roman numerals.

The first word after a colon should be capitalized only if it is a proper noun or introduces a sentence.

If a quotation fragment is used in a sentence, an upper case or lower case letter in the original quotation may be altered to suit its position in the new sentence.

Names of the seasons are not capitalized. Note that seasons should not generally be used as a frame of reference, as they vary according to the hemisphere. Exceptions may be made for training materials aimed at a specific country or region. As a season, use autumn, not fall.

Capitalization of brand and trade names should reflect the registered version of the name, such as YouTube and InDesign.

Capitals are used to distinguish the specific from the generic or non-specific:

- Use capital letters when naming a specific body, e.g. The Government of France ruled that … but not when referring to a body more generally, e.g. All participating governments were asked to comment on the ruling.
- Organizations, committees, universities, laws, treaties, governments and so on take initial capitals when the full title is given, but not when referred to subsequently without the full title, e.g. The Government of Malawi has stated that the policy is being drafted. The goal of the policy is to give the government more control, according to the minister. See 6.1 FAO-related terminology for the exceptions to this rule.
- For geographical and political designations, use upper case only if part of the official name. For example, the word state takes a lower case s when referring generally to the institution or to nations or divisions of a nation, e.g. state-owned enterprise; it takes a capital S when a specific state is named, e.g. State of Andhra Pradesh.
- For formal or job titles, use upper case only if it comes before a person's name or directly following the name, e.g. Prime Minister Anderson or Jennifer Smith, Director of Communications, spoke to the press. Use lower case when a title is separated from the person's name, e.g. Qu Dongyu, the ninth director-general of FAO, was elected in 2019.
- Use initial capitals for historical eras and events (the First World War), declarations and conventions when the full title is given.
- Names of stars and planets (e.g. the Sun, the Earth) should be capitalized where treated as proper nouns. Where earth is used to refer to ground or soil, the word is not capitalized. Where sun is used generically, it should be lower case, e.g. The cacao beans are dried in the sun.

- When referring to a specific figure or table in the text, use a capital letter, e.g. see Table 1.3. When referring to more than one figure or table, refer to each separately, e.g. As shown in Figure 2 and Figure 3 (not As shown in Figures 2 and 3). Note that capitals are not used when the term is used in a general sense, e.g. The tables show a trend of ....

8.1 TITLES AND HEADINGS

In headings, subheadings and book titles, use sentence case, i.e. capitals only for the initial letter of the phrase and any proper names. If the title is based on a conference, workshop, government programme, project name or journal whose title was capitalized, retain the capitalization. Note that designers may choose to use all upper case for titles or headings, but the capitalization rules should be followed in the citation.

Capitalize the initial letter of the first word, the final word and major words of series titles, e.g. Microbiological Risk Assessment Series.

8.2 REGIONS AND GROUPS OF PEOPLE

For regions, capitalize when part of a proper name or political grouping, e.g. the representatives of Southeast Asia, the Near East and Eastern Europe, but not for a generic geographical grouping, e.g. a species common across eastern Europe. The naming of regions across the world can also carry cultural, historical or traditional connotations and for this reason upper case may often be appropriate depending on context; be consistent throughout the document.

Adjectives derived from these names (e.g. Near Eastern, North African) are also capitalized. Do not capitalize, however, where a hyphen is part of a prefixed word, e.g. sub-Saharan Africa.

Names of Indigenous Peoples and ethnic and national groups take an initial capital and are not italicized, e.g. the San people.

9 _ ITALICS, BOLD AND UNDERLINING

9.1 ITALICS

Italic font is used for:

- emphasis, as sparingly as possible (note that when the body text is in italics, roman type should be used for emphasis);
- book and journal titles in all languages (titles of chapters and articles are not italicized); website names; titles of paintings and sculptures in all languages; plays, films, and radio and television programmes in all languages; and names of ships (prefixes such as SS or HMS are not italicized);
- mathematical variables, e.g. $2x + 3p$;
- names of legal cases or judgments, e.g. *State of Wyoming v. Jameson*;
- the indication of genera, species and subspecies (see also 6.3.3 Scientific names); and
- some foreign words and phrases. See 6.4 Foreign languages for more information.

Note that only words italicized in the original text should be italicized within a direct quote.

9.2 BOLD

Authors' names may be in bold in reference lists and in the source notes under figures, tables and boxes. This is optional, provided it is consistent throughout the document. (See 12 Referencing and crediting sources). In the text, avoid bold unless there is a clear purpose, such as emphasis.

9.3 UNDERLINING

Hyperlinked text should be underlined. The exception to this rule is URLs, from which an underline may be removed.

10 _ NUMBERS

Numbers from one to ten inclusive are written in text as words, whereas numbers from 11 upward are written as numerals, with the following exceptions:

- Always use arabic numerals for dates, percentages, money, measurements, ages, ratios and scales.
- Write out any number that begins a sentence, e.g. **Fifteen** people were present.
- Use numerals where a number accompanies a unit, e.g. **5** cm, **7** percent, USD **2**.
- When providing two or more numbers that refer to the same subject and at least one of them is over ten, use arabic numerals, e.g. The number of replies varied, ranging between **2** and **12** per group.
- For units of time, applying the rule can be at the discretion of the writer, as long as it is consistent throughout the document (**5** days or **five** days).

For decimals:

- Use a point (a full stop, not a comma), e.g. 14.36.
- Use a zero before the decimal point for numbers smaller than 1, e.g. **0**.23.
- Use the plural for any decimal number above 1.0, e.g. **1.5** days.

For large values:

- Use spaces, not full stops or commas, to denote thousands (e.g. 10 000; 125 500). Use non-breaking spaces to avoid number divisions at the end of lines. It is acceptable to write 1000 through 9999 with no space where a space would look awkward (particularly in titles or headings) and when it is not specifically compared with another number in the thousands or higher, where the space would be required, e.g. between **5 000** and **10 000**.
- Do not use spaces for years (e.g. 2007) or page numbers (e.g. p. 1402).
- For millions, use numerals separated by non-breaking spaces (e.g. 150 324 399) unless the last six numerals are zeros, in which case express these digits as million (e.g. 150 000 000 should be written as 150 **million**). The same principle holds for billions, trillions, etc. Data are in general reported to three significant figures.
- FAO uses the short scale for billions and trillions: 1 billion = one thousand million or 1 000 000 000 (10^9); 1 trillion = one million million or 1 000 000 000 000 (10^{12}).

Write fractions in words rather than numbers, using a hyphen, e.g. one-third.

Avoid the use of roman numerals except in established terminology, e.g. **Type II** error.

Where possible, write out ordinal numbers in full, e.g. the **Thirteenth** Session of the FAO Committee on Fisheries. Where it is necessary to use numerals, do not use superscript for the ordinal indicator, e.g. the **13th** Session, not the 13th Session.

Avoid the use of adverbial ordinal numbers (firstly, secondly, thirdly, etc.), as subsequent numbers sound awkward. Replace these with first, second, third, etc.

For telephone numbers, be consistent in the use of parentheses and spaces. Always include the country code using this format: (+39) or (+505). The recommended style is: (+39) 06 57057051.

To refer to a specific page: p. 40. To refer to a page range: pp. 40–42. To refer to the total number of pages in a publication: 120 pp.

10.1 UNITS

Use the International System of Units (metric system) with equivalents in parentheses if necessary.

In general, use tonnes (equal to 1000 kg), not tons (2240 lb or approximately 1016 kg). A tonne is sometimes referred to in the United States as a metric ton, but always use the word tonne. A megatonne (Mt) is equivalent to one million tonnes.
For shipping, tons may however be appropriate. A shipping ton is used to measure the volume of freight, equivalent to 40 cubic feet (1.1 m^3) in the United States, or 42 cubic feet (1.2 m^3) in the United Kingdom.

Always give temperature in Celsius, not Fahrenheit, e.g. 35.5 °C.

TABLE 10.1 _ Common units

Unit	Symbol
metre	m
square metre	m^2
cubic metre	m^3
micron	µ
litre	l,L
gram	g
tonne	t
second	s
degree Celsius	°C
degree absolute	K
Kilocalorie	kcal
hour	h

Source: Adapted from **Bureau International des Poids et Mesures**. 2019. *The International System of Units (SI)*. [Cited 1 October 2021]. https://www.bipm.org/documents/20126/41483022/SI-Brochure-9-EN.pdf/2d2b50bf-f2b4-9661-f402-5f9d66e4b507

Do not use punctuation or letter spacing in such units as cm, mm, g, °C. Note, however, that there should always be a non-breaking space between the number and the unit, e.g. 3 cm, 70 g, 37 °C.

Do not use the plural for abbreviations of units (e.g. 7 **kg**, not 7 kgs). To indicate per, use /, as in 3 **m/s** (rather than 3 $m\ s^{-1}$).

Avoid combinations of three units such as: Production is 25 tonnes/ha/year. Prefer: **Annual** production is **25 tonnes/ha**. Exceptions may be made for statistical documents.

In series of measurements, use the symbol each time: 10 **cm**, 20 **cm** and 50 **cm**, not 10, 20 and 50 cm.

Correct ways of writing latitude and longitude include: 10°30' north; 90° west; the zone from 10° to 40° north. Use the abbreviations N, E, S and W only in tables. For minutes and seconds of latitude or longitude (41°16'40" south) a straight apostrophe or straight quotation mark may be used rather than the prime symbol (′).

If your reader may not immediately understand the unit abbreviation, include it in the list of abbreviations or spell out the full name once: 100 hectares (ha).

10.2 PERCENTAGES

Use percent (never per cent) rather than the symbol % in text, e.g. Exports increased by 16 **percent** in the last quarter. In tables and figures, use the symbol with no space between the number and the symbol, e.g. 16%.

10.3 DATES

Write dates in this order: Monday, 16 October 2000 (with no comma between the date and the month, or the month and the year). Do not use ordinal numbers for dates (e.g. 1 January, not 1st January).

Avoid starting a sentence with a year, but if it is unavoidable it must be written out: **Nineteen ninety-eight** was not a leap year. Do not abbreviate years, e.g. 1985, not '85. Decades are referred to in complete numerals (e.g. the 1990s; not the nineties, the '90s or the 90s).

When indicating a range of values or dates, there are two possible forms:

- from … to or between … and, e.g. from 1970 to 1987; or
- with an en-dash, e.g. The 1970–1987 period was …

Do not combine the two forms, e.g. from 1970–1987.

A standard range of dates (2015–2025; from 2015 to 2025) implies the whole period from the beginning of 2015 to the end of 2025 inclusive. Note that for a crop or fiscal year, exceptionally, an abbreviated version should be used (2015/16, not 2015/2016). When used in tables, multiyear ranges or averages may take a hyphen to denote the three-year period and an en-dash between the two sets, e.g. 1997-99–2015-17.

Centuries should be written out in full, e.g. the twenty-first century, not the 21st century.

Where necessary to avoid confusion, use BCE (before Common Era) or CE (Common Era) for dates, placing the abbreviation after the year (e.g. 1000 **BCE**).

10.4 TIME

The use of the 24-hour system is preferred, e.g. 08.00, 13.30. Where it is necessary to use the 12-hour system, use full stops as follows: 8 a.m. , 1.30 p.m. Be consistent.

Use a non-breaking space between the number and the unit.

When referring to time zones, prefer Universal Time Coordinated, i.e. UTC + or –. For example, The meeting will be held at 17.00 **(UTC +6)**.

10.5 CURRENCIES

Rather than the currency symbol (which sometimes fails to convert across different software programs), use the ISO currency code given in NOCS, with a non-breaking space between the code and the amount, e.g. **USD** 700 000 rather than US$700,000 and **EUR** 800 000 rather than €800,000. For amounts of less than one unit of currency, use a zero followed by a decimal point (i.e. USD 0.20 rather than 20 cents).

To facilitate comparison of amounts in different currencies within a text, try to give an indicative equivalent in USD, or provide an exchange rate (either in a footnote or following the list of abbreviations). The exchange rate provided or the one used to calculate the indicative equivalent should be that valid at the date referenced, rather than at the time of writing or editing.

10.6 MATHEMATICS AND EQUATIONS

Relational and operational signs have a space on either side of them (e.g. 3 + 2 = 5). Use the multiplication sign ×, not lower case letter x. Use the minus symbol –, not the hyphen - or en-dash –. Use the minus symbol when indicating a negative number. See Appendix 3 Useful shortcuts and functions in Microsoft Word.

Symbols used for variables, including Greek characters, should be italicized.

In chemical formulae, use subscript (indicating molecules), e.g. CO_2. Only use CO2 where it is impossible to use subscript. Superscript indicates atomic charge, as in Ba^{2+}.

11 _ NOTATION (inserting endnotes and footnotes)

Notation is a way of providing more information to the reader without cluttering the text. Here, we describe how endnotes and footnotes may be used in FAO knowledge products to cite sources and provide informational notes.

11.1 FORMATTING

Endnotes and footnotes are identified in front matter, main text and end matter with an indicator (a superscript number, a superscript letter or a symbol). This same indicator (e.g.*) precedes the correlating note. In figures, tables and boxes, endnotes and footnotes do not require an indicator if the information in the note refers to the entire element. When possible, avoid putting note indicators in titles, headings and sub-headings.

TABLE 11.1 _ Indicators for endnotes and footnotes

	Front matter	Main text & end matter	Figures, tables & boxes
Providing general notes	**FOOTNOTES** Prefer [1, 2, 3] Use [a, b, c] when endnotes are used in the main text	**FOOTNOTES** Prefer [1, 2, 3] Use [a, b, c] when endnotes are used in the main text	**FOOTNOTES** Notes follow the heading *Note:* or *Notes:* Optionally use ***, †, ‡, §, ‖, #**
Citing sources	**FOOTNOTES** Combine with general footnotes	**AUTHOR-DATE** OR **ENDNOTES** Use [1, 2, 3] for endnotes	**FOOTNOTES** Notes follow the heading *Source:* or *Sources:* Optionally use [i, ii, iii]

Note: If using letters for footnotes and there are more than 26 footnotes, continue with aa, ab, ac, and subsequently aaa, aab, aac. Letters and roman numerals should always be lower case. Assign symbols in the following order: * (asterisk), † (dagger), ‡ (double dagger), § (section mark), ‖ (parallels), # (number sign). Do not use * (asterisk) if *p* values occur in the table. When there are many notes, symbols may be doubled, tripled and so on.

In text, the note indicator (a superscript number or letter or a symbol) should be placed close to the idea it refers to, whether that is at the end of a sentence or within a sentence. Where placed at the end of a sentence, it should follow terminal punctuation. This is an example.[1] Where used within a sentence, if it is next to punctuation, the indicator should be placed after the punctuation: The process failed to respect the standard procedure,[2] which explains the extreme values. However, if the indicator is next to an en-dash[3] – it should come after the word preceding the en-dash.

When inserting two or more indicators in text, separate them with a comma followed by a non-breaking space. When inserting both endnote and footnote indicators at the same place, footnote indicators come first. This is an example of two footnote indicators and an endnote indicator.[d, e, 5]

If there are several consecutive numbers cited, Zotero will automatically collapse the numbers, e.g. according to reports.[81–4, 97]

In the correlating note, footnote indicators are superscript while endnote indicators may be superscript or not. The indicator is followed by a space, and the note should be in sentence format:

[e] China is distinguished from China (mainland) throughout this report.

11.2 ENDNOTES

Endnotes are not used for general notes. The endnote system is one of the two systems available for citing references in the main text and end matter of a publication, described in 12.3.2 Endnote system (in-text). Endnotes may also be used for stand-alone elements. See 12.4 Referencing in figures, tables and boxes for how to correctly source stand-alone elements.

The endnote referencing system provides each source with a unique indicator, based on first appearance in the text, to avoid duplication in the bibliographic list. Endnote numbering may be continuous throughout the publication, or it may restart for the end matter. For large books, an exception may be made to allow numbering to restart for each major section of the book.

11.3 FOOTNOTES

Footnotes are used in the main text and end matter to provide the reader with informational notes only. In front matter and in figures, tables and boxes, footnotes include both informational notes and source references.

11.3.1 Footnotes in front matter, main text and end matter

In front matter, main text and end matter, each footnote receives a new indicator. Footnotes are placed at the foot of the page, preceded by the indicator. The sequence of indicators may be continuous throughout the publication. Or if preferred, the sequence may be restarted for the main text and again for the end matter; for each part of the main text; or even for each page – so long as it is consistent.

11.3.2 Footnotes in figures, tables and boxes

In stand-alone elements, some footnotes receive an indicator, while other footnotes referring to the entire element do not. Footnotes are placed directly below stand-alone elements and are subcategorized by the information they provide.

- *Note:* or *Notes:* for informational notes.
- *Source:* or *Sources:* for references to all the source material for the element.
- *Download:* for a single DOI, formatted as a URL, for downloadable data; see 11.4 Download notes.

Within those subcategories, notes that refer to the entire element are not marked with an indicator and precede any notes that have been given an indicator. Any indicators should be inserted left to right and top to bottom and restarted for each figure, table and box. Within a figure, table or box, an indicator can be reused to refer to the same note.

Figure 11.1 _ An example of how to place informational and source citation footnotes in a stand-alone element

Vestibulum	Fauci bus	Bibendum
Lorem ipsum	Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit*	Cras malesuada enim ac ligula egestas volutpat.
Integer eget	Integer eget risus at elit gravida ullamcorper et vel dui[i]	Sed vel nisl sagittis, malesuada dui quis, bibendum odio.
Morbi malesuada	Maecenas rhoncus arcu ut tincidunt finibus[ii]	Ut laoreet diam sed sollicitudin ornare
Etiam id diam	Sed dapibus felis vel dictum finibus*	Vestibulum euismod libero blandit dignissim dictum**

Notes: This is a note providing information about the entire table.
* This is a note providing information about a specific part, or specific parts, of the table.
** This is another note providing information about a specific part, or specific parts, of the table.
Sources:
Adapted from **Scorsese, V.** 2017. A review of Robert De Niro and Martin Scorsese's collaboration. Los Angeles, USA.
[i] **De Niro, R.** 2022. Reaching your audience. London, Publisher.
[ii] **Scorsese, M.** 2020. Improving relationships. Marketing Today, 6: 30–35.

11.4 DOWNLOAD NOTES

The download note is used only when a dataset has a unique digital object identifier (DOI). Add *Download:* or alternatively a symbol, such as ⭳, below any footnotes or source notes, and insert the DOI URL for the dataset only.

12 _ REFERENCING AND CREDITING SOURCES

Proper referencing of all source material is important for the credibility of FAO communication and information products and to avoid inadvertent plagiarism.

For the purposes of this publication, a **citation** is the shorthand within the text that points to the reference. A **reference** is the string of terms (author, date, title, publisher, etc.) that identifies the source. A **source** is the place (publication, website, database, etc.) the information was borrowed from.

FAO has developed its own referencing styles. These styles share some elements with, but nevertheless differ from, the most common referencing systems (APA, Chicago, Harvard, MLA).

When borrowing material, check whether there is a required citation and revise to match FAOSTYLE. Where permission has been obtained to use third-party content, the reference should include Reproduced with permission.

Personal communications do not appear in a bibliographic list and are cited in the text using parentheses, e.g. (R. Wright, personal communication, 2000). Social media comments, messages and direct replies should be treated as personal communications; an example from a social media platform is: (Facebook direct message to author, 30 April 2017).

12.1 ARTWORK, PHOTOGRAPHS AND OTHER IMAGES

When original artwork is created for the publication, it is often required to mention the creator. This is typically done in the acknowledgements or on the copyright page. A citation for each element they create is not required.

All photos must carry a credit line adjacent to the photo stating the copyright holder and the photographer, if known, and any other obligatory information required by the source of the photo. Credit FAO as well as the photographer where it is the work of a staff member or a remunerated external collaborator whose duties include photography, in particular where FAO provided the equipment, i.e. © FAO/Robert Smith. Credit the individual if the photo was taken by a staff member or collaborator outside their official duties, or by a person external to FAO, i.e. © Robert Smith. Where the name of the photographer is not known, just put © FAO.

For cover photographs, add: Cover photograph: before the credit. See 2.1.3.2 Copyright page for placement.

If you are negotiating rights with a third party, check whether you are obligated to apply their policy for photo credits or captions.

Always ensure that required permissions have been obtained, preferably using the Permission Request Form (contact copyright@fao.org for further information).

If previously published visuals (such as a poster, infographic or illustration) are inserted, they are considered figures. Apply a credit line to each like a photo: © FAO/Jon Marsh. Screenshots are discouraged, but if they are necessary, insert the copyright credit for the owner of the website. (Note that screenshots should ideally be taken with a Mac as the resolution will be higher.) However, if these figures are heavily cited or directly quoted in the text, use standard in-text citation and a bibliographic entry. The copyright holder is the corporate author if no individual author is available. Be sure to identify the medium in the full source, e.g. **FAO.** 2021. Assessing climate change vulnerability in Dieppe Bay fisheries using value chain analysis [poster]. Rome. https://openknowledge.fao.org/handle/20.500.14283/cb6528en

12.2 REFERENCING IN FRONT MATTER (PRELIMINARY PAGES)

In front matter, it is best practice to use footnotes for both sources and general notes; include the full reference in the footnote and do not include these sources in the bibliographic list (unless they are also cited in the main text). Each note, whether it is a general note or source reference, receives a separate number (this means a reference may appear more than once). See 11 Notation (inserting endnotes and footnotes) for how to format and insert footnotes.

12.3 REFERENCING IN MAIN TEXT AND END MATTER

There are two different systems for referencing source material in the main text of FAO information products: the author–date system and the endnote system. Only one system may be used within an information product.

12.3.1 Author–date system (in-text)

For in-text citations, the author's name is followed by the year of publication of the source, e.g. This point has been demonstrated in a recent report (Costa and Gilles, 2016). It is not necessary to indicate the page number unless text is quoted. For sourcing quoted text, see 12.3.3 Direct quotes (both systems).

Use and between the last two author names with no comma. Do not use the ampersand (&). Use a semicolon between different citations unless they are from the same author.

Generally, in-text citations should be organized alphabetically, chronologically, in order of presentation, or in order of importance and should be consistent within the document.

In-text citations should be presented as follows:

- one work, one author:
  as demonstrated by Sanders (2008) or as the study demonstrated (Sanders, 2008)
- one work, up to three authors:
  according to a recent report (Sanders, Cohen and Bolbol, 2010)
- one work, more than three authors unless there are multiple sources with the same first author and year, in that case, provide a clear distinction between different sources:
  as stated in a recent survey (Sanders *et al.*, 2011)
- more than one work by different authors:
  as various studies demonstrate (Sanders, 2008; Murguía, 2010) or as various studies demonstrate (Sanders, 2008; Murguía, 2010; Bekele *et al.*, 2007)

- more than one work by the same author:
  (Sanders, 2001, 2004, 2009a, 2009b)
- different authors with the same surname:
  (Sanders, J., 2009; Sanders, B., 1999)
- edited works:
  (Sanders, ed., 2008) or according to Sanders (ed., 2008)
- when referring to a source cited within another source (indirect reference, or secondary source), refer to the one you consulted, not the original:
  as demonstrated by Sanders (cited in Murguía, 2008)
- as an exception, when referring to a single idea that cites more than three sources, use a footnote to cite all the sources:
  [66]See Australia, 1982; Azerbaijan, 1995; Jamaica, 1947; South Africa, 2008; and Thailand, 1973.

12.3.2 Endnote system (in-text)

Where applying the endnote referencing system,[1] each source receives a unique key;[2] therefore, an endnote key may be reused if the same source is cited multiple times.[1] The notes will appear in order of first appearance[1] in the corresponding list of bibliographic content at the end of the publication (or section), which is labelled Notes, as below.[2, 3]

Notes

1 First source
2 Second source
3 Third source

It is best practice to not use endnotes in front matter. For how to source references in front matter, see 12.2 Referencing in front matter (preliminary pages).

12.3.3 Direct quotes (both systems)

Enclose the quoted material in double quotation marks:

- Author–date: McKinsey and Company (2009, p. 9) state that "in forestry and agriculture, both costs and investments are relatively low."
- Endnote: McKinsey and Company (p. 9) state that "in forestry and agriculture, both costs and investments are relatively low."[2]

For longer quoted text of approximately three or more lines, use block quotations. These are introduced by a colon, indented, and do not have quotation marks:

- Author–date:
  As stated in the document:
  Ensuring food security and nutrition at the household and global levels requires investing in nutrition-sensitive agriculture, protecting women's rights and improving their social and nutritional status (FAO, 2011, p. 3).

- Endnote:
  As stated in the document, p. 3:
  Ensuring food security and nutrition at the household and global levels requires investing in nutrition-sensitive agriculture, protecting women's rights and improving their social and nutritional status.[4]

Quotations should follow the presentation (italics, bold, capitals, underline, etc.) of the original. Do not apply FAOSTYLE to quoted matter unless the quote was from a spoken source.

12.4 REFERENCING IN FIGURES, TABLES AND BOXES

Each stand-alone element that contains sourced data must have a complete list of references. The list is placed below the element, following any informational notes, and given the heading *Source:* or *Sources:*

If the list is very long, it may be moved to the bibliography, where it should be inserted after the list of sources from the main text and end matter and given an appropriate subtitle. Direct the reader to the list of references by providing a clear cross-reference to its location, e.g. *Sources*: See References.

If sources refer to specific data points and not to the entire figure, table or box, refer to Table 11.1 Indicators for endnotes and footnotes.

References may begin with Adapted from or Reproduced with permission from.

When (optionally) citing the author of the publication as the author of a figure or table, the preferred format is:

- For one author: *Source*: Author's own elaboration.
- For multiple authors: *Source*: Authors' own elaboration.

Refer to FAO guidance for maps to correctly credit author modifications to maps.

If using Zotero, sources for figures, tables and boxes may need to be added manually.

12.5 BIBLIOGRAPHIC INFORMATION

This section, called References when using author-date citations, and called Notes when using the endnote system, contains bibliographic information for the sources cited in the main text and end matter. A long book, or one with sources unique to each chapter or section, may have a Notes or References section at the end of each chapter or section. Include each chapter or section's reference list in the table of contents.

Regardless of which system is used, FAO (unlike some publishers) applies the same order of elements and formatting of the full bibliographic reference. The basic format for both systems is as follows:

Author. Year. *Title*. Place, Publisher.

Ideally, references for non-cited sources are formatted in the same way as references for cited sources. When a publication does not include cited sources in the text but does include a list of referenced material, use the section title Bibliography and list the entries in alphabetical order (not numbered) by author.

12.5.1 Author–date (References)

Under the section title References, the list of references is alphabetical. The list is alphabetical by author's surname; then by co-authors' surnames (independent of the number of co-authors); then chronologically in ascending order by publication date (oldest first, e.g. 2019 before 2021). Where there are two or more titles by the same author in the same year, distinguish the sources from each other by using a, b, c, etc. as necessary after the year. The lettering is determined by the order in which the works are first cited in the text, with the first work mentioned being assigned the letter a, e.g. 2008**a**. Example:

FAO. 2019. ...
FAO. 2020. ...
WHO. 2020a. ...
WHO. 2020b. ...

For suggested reading or additional resources, change the title of the section from References to Bibliography and insert the subtitles References (for cited sources) and either Further reading or Additional resources (for non-cited sources).

12.5.2 Endnotes (Notes)

Under the section title Notes, the list of references is numbered (ordered by the first appearance of a citation in the text).

This list follows the order of appearance in the main text:

1. **WHO**. 2020. ...

2. **FAO**. 2020. ...

3. **FAO**. 2019. ...

4. **WHO**. 2021. ...

If needed, add a Further reading or Additional resources section immediately after Notes to accommodate sources not cited in the text. This section should not be numbered and should be in alphabetical order by author.

12.6 WRITING OR GENERATING BIBLIOGRAPHIC LISTS

Some guidelines:

- Corporate authors are typically identified by and therefore alphabetized by their abbreviation. Best practice is to provide your reader access to the full name of the corporate author, whether through a list of abbreviations or in the bibliographic list itself, e.g.:
  ICAO (International Civil Aviation Organization). 2017. *(first use)*
  ICAO. 2020. *(second use)*
  Make manual modifications as necessary to ensure consistency when using Zotero.
- For works with more than ten authors, only the first seven must be listed; the rest may optionally be truncated using *et al.*
- Use and or the ampersand (&) between the names of the last two authors in each reference, e.g.: **Sanders, J., Cohen, L. & Bolbol, M.** 2010. ....
- Titles of books, journals, papers, periodicals and websites are italicized, including titles in foreign languages. Titles of articles, presentations and chapters are not italicized, including titles in foreign languages.
- Titles of FAO information products use sentence case, whereas meetings, official days and years, projects and conferences are given initial capitalization.
- Bold can be used (optionally) for author names only: **Munro, G.R.** 2010. *From drain to* ....
- The city and country of publication come before the publisher, e.g. Montreal, Canada, ICAO. When the city is the capital, the country is omitted, e.g. Ankara, FAO.
- The United States of America and the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland may be abbreviated to USA and UK in references. Omit other geographical or administrative details, such as county, state, province and district with the exception of Washington, DC.
- If multiple locations are provided, format as location per publisher (e.g. Rome, FAO & Quebec City, Canada, CINE). Otherwise, format as usual (e.g. Cairo, FAO, CIRAD & CIHEAM).
- Information products that have not yet been published at the time of writing should be cited as forthcoming. Thus:
  (Brandt, forthcoming) *(in-text citation)*
  Brandt, S. (forthcoming). *Title* ... (reference list)
- When possible, provide the DOI as a URL access point. If there is no DOI, provide the link to the preview page (for the FAO Knowledge Repository, this will be the handle URL, e.g. https://openknowledge.fao.org/handle/20.500.14283/cc7724en). If there is no DOI and no preview page, provide a shortened or full URL that points directly to the source of the material. URLs may optionally be underlined and should not have angled brackets < >. Include the full address as it is copied from the browser, including http:// or https://.
- In the bibliographic list, use either the full titles of the journals or their abbreviated titles in all entries (be consistent). Abbreviated titles should use the standard abbreviation for the journals. There are lists of journal abbreviations available online, generally grouped by sector.
- References (author–date) may be broken into subsections if helpful to the reader, especially in the case of complex, heavily cited documents.

- Notes (endnote system) may include a subtitle such as Annexes or Appendices if endnotes are restarted for end matter.
- When referencing a web page that is contained within a website, indicate the name of the website after the title of the cited piece starting with In:, e.g. **World Bank**. 2019. Understanding poverty. In: *The World Bank*. Washington, DC. [Cited 3 April 2019]. www.worldbank.org/en/topic/poverty/overview
- Insert the date the source was accessed inside square brackets before the URL. Use this format: [Cited 24 June 2023].
- For static (non-changing) sources such as PDFs and DOIs, omitting a cited date is permitted.

Box 12.1 _ Best practices for non-English sources

- When the language of the publication and the language of a source are not the same, updating the source to a corresponding full version in the language of the publication is the best possible solution.
- If only a translated summary is available, cite the full original source and add the title of the summary (in parentheses) following the title.
- If no official translation exists, provide a translated title [in square brackets] following the original language title, e.g. Sổ tay hỏi đáp về thực hành tốt và an toàn sinh học trong chăn nuôi vịt, ngan (vịt xiêm) bố mẹ quy mô vừa và nhỏ [Questions and answers handbook for good management practices and biosecurity in small- and medium-scale parent ducks/Muscovy ducks farming].
- When translating an information product, regardless of the language of the source, put all words that are not copied directly from the work, such as forthcoming, Cited and eds. into the language of the translated publication.

12.7 FORMATTING CITATIONS AND BIBLIOGRAPHIC LISTS

12.7.1 Manual formatting

If you intend to input reference entries manually, please refer to 12.8 Examples of bibliographic style.

12.7.2 Automatic formatting

Bibliographic software, such as EndNote, Mendeley, RefWorks and Zotero, can facilitate the generation of citations and bibliographic entries. Such tools save time and remove the drudgery of formatting citations and generating bibliographies. FAO bibliographic style in Citation Style Language (CSL) is available for use with Zotero. For guidance, see Appendix 4 Installing and using Zotero.

In addition, the FAO Library has licensing arrangements for EndNote, with FAOSTYLE citations. If you prefer to use EndNote, please contact the FAO Library.

With video tutorials available, even beginners can start using these tools within minutes to input records manually (completing standard fields such as author, title and year) or automatically (using metadata from web pages and PDFs). The records can be downloaded as necessary in the form of reference entries already formatted in FAO bibliographic style. The records will remain in a master file (or can be grouped in appropriate subfolders) for use in future information products. They can be exported and shared with other colleagues. In this way, a unit can compile a large master file of citation entries.

Although software tools can capture most elements required for citations, it may be necessary to make some manual edits.

12.8 EXAMPLES OF BIBLIOGRAPHIC STYLE

General templates are provided below, followed by example lists. Replace the black text with information from the source; the text in green remains as shown here. Note that some items are not required if not applicable, e.g. the author or place of publication for a web page, or the agency that adopted a legal instrument.

- Online publication

Author. Year of publication. *Publication title*. Series title, Series number. Place of publication, Publisher. URL

- Print publication

Author. Year of publication. *Publication title*. Series title, Series number. Place of publication, Publisher.

- Website or webpage

Author. Year of publication, or n.d. if not known. Web page title. Text by Surname, Initials. In: *Website identity*. [Cited DD Month YYYY]. URL

- Database

Author. Year of last update. Name of database: Name of dataset OR Name of database. [Accessed on DD Month YYYY]. URL. Licence: CC Licence.

- Legal case

Name v. Name. Court name, date. Codes.

- International instrument (international or regional, binding or non-binding)

Name (Alternative name or abbreviation). Agency, Place, date. Codes.

- National and supranational legislation (national, supranational, regional)

Country or region, etc. Name of legislation, date. Codes. [OPTIONAL:] Also available at: [URL of database, e.g. FAOLEX URL]

12.8.1 Sample references

This is organized following the rules for a references or bibliography section of a publication using the author–date system of referencing. To see an example of a notes list for the endnote system, refer to 11 Notation (inserting endnotes and footnotes).

Table 12.1 _ List of reference examples with notes

References	Format, comments
Allison, E. & McBride, R. 2003. Education reform for improved natural resource management: Fisheries and aquaculture in Bangladeshi Universities. *Society and Natural Resources*, 16(3): 249–263.	Journal article
Arnason, R. 1984. Efficient harvesting of fish stocks: The case of the Icelandic demersal fisheries. Vancouver, Canada, University of British Columbia. PhD dissertation.	Thesis or dissertation; also an example of adding notation
Baltzer, K. & Hansen, H. 2011. *Agricultural input subsidies in sub-Saharan Africa. Evaluation study*. Copenhagen, DANIDA. https://web-archive.oecd.org/derec/denmark/49231998.pdf. Internal document.	Internal document or paper; online reference that includes a notation
Bartley, D.M. & Leber, K.M., eds. 2004. *Marine ranching*. FAO Fisheries Technical Paper, No. 429. Rome, FAO.	Series title
Electronic livestock identification system. United States of America. No. 4 262 632, filed 25 April 1974, and issued 21 April 1981. https://patentimages.storage.googleapis.com/6c/49/f1/e746f5f7bca33e/US4262632.pdf	Patent
FAO. 2021a. Assessing climate change vulnerability in Dieppe Bay's fisheries using value chain analysis [poster]. Rome. https://openknowledge.fao.org/handle/20.500.14283/cb6528en	Poster; also duplicate author and year entries marked with a and b
FAO. 2021b. *FAOSTAT: Crops*. [Accessed on 1 March 2021]. https://www.fao.org/faostat/en/#data/QC. Licence: CC-BY-4.0.	Database; also example of duplicate author and year (see previous entry)
FAO. 2022. Food Outlook – Biannual Report on Global Food Markets. Food Outlook, November 2022 [.mobi edition]. Rome. [Cited 15 December 2022]. https://openknowledge.fao.org/handle/20.500.14283/cc2864en	E-book, .mobi edition

References	Format, comments
FAO. 2023a. *A new generation of Syrian agricultural entrepreneurs* [audio recording]. Rome. [Cited 18 November 2024]. https://digital-media.fao.org/Package/2A6XC5FUVQ#/SearchResult&VBID=2A6XUVV36ZVS&PN=1&WS=PackagePres	Audio recording
FAO. 2023b. *FAO in Emergencies - Rein Paulsen, Director of FAO's Office of Emergencies and Resilience* [video]. [Cited 4 May 2023]. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=neUjNfi8gHY	Video
FAO (@FAO). 2024a. "*Did you know that trees in cities absorb pollutant gases from traffic & industry? *They also filter fine particulates like dust, dirt & smoke, which help shield urban populations from respiratory diseases. #WorldCleanAirDay #CleanAirNow #GreenCities." In: *X*, 7 September 2024. [Text & video]. [Cited 12 September 2024]. https://x.com/FAO/status/1832380796877074606. Asterisks represent emojis.	Social media post (cite in text only, unless it is important to provide a link; if including a full citation, quote as much of the content as possible up to 160 characters, but do not duplicate content quoted in the main text); in-text citation for full reference in this case is (FAO [@FAO], 2024); if the content includes emojis, replace each emoji with an asterisk (*) and an explanatory note
FAO. 2024b. FishStat: Global aquaculture production 1950–2022. [Accessed on 29 March 2024]. In: *FishStatJ*. Available at www.fao.org/fishery/en/statistics/software/fishstatj. Licence: CC-BY-4.0.	Dataset accessed via a software programme
FAO & WHO. 2022. *CODEX – A year in transition*. Codex Alimentarius Magazine, 2022. Codex Alimentarius Commission. Rome. https://doi.org/10.4060/cc3141en	A publication produced by an Article 14 or statutory body may optionally include the name of the body before the place of publication
Giel, T., Bijman, J. & Oorthuizen, J. 2007. *Producer organisations and market chains* [CD-ROM]. Wageningen, Kingdom of the Netherlands, Agri-Profocus.	CD-ROM or DVD
Glanz, J. & Armendariz, A. 2017. Years of ethics charges, but star cancer researcher gets a pass. *The New York Times*, 8 March 2017. New York, USA. [Cited 1 March 2021]. https://www.nytimes.com/2017/03/08/science/cancer-carlo-croce.html	Newspaper article
Grant, S., Nener, J., MacDonald, B., Boldt, J., King, J., Patterson, D., Robinson, K. & Wheeler, S. 2021. Canadian Fraser River Sockeye Salmon: A Case Study. This volume, chapter 16.	Edited book with chapter authorship; citing a different chapter within the book

References	Format, comments
Grant, S., Nener, J., MacDonald, B., Boldt, J., King, J., Patterson, D., Robinson, K. & Wheeler, S. (forthcoming). Canadian Fraser River Sockeye Salmon: A Case Study. In: T. Bahri, M. Vasconcellos, D.J. Welch, J. Johnson, R.I. Perry, X. Ma & R. Sharma, eds. *Adaptive management of fisheries in response to climate change*. FAO Fisheries and Aquaculture Technical Paper, No. 667. Rome, FAO.	Edited publication with chapter authorship
IMO (International Maritime Organization). n.d. *IMO*. [Cited 15 February 2017]. https://www.imo.org	Website
IPPC Secretariat. 2017. *Recognition of pest free areas and areas of low pest prevalence.* International Standard for Phytosanitary Measures, No. 29. Rome, FAO on behalf of the Secretariat of the International Plant Protection Convention. Adopted 2007.	Reference that includes a notation
Johnson, Kwame. Interview by Maria Rogers [personal interview]. Kampala, 1 October 2022.	Unpublished interview
Markandya, A. 2023. *Accounting for the hidden costs of agrifood systems in data-scarce contexts – Background paper for The State of Food and Agriculture 2023*. FAO Agricultural Development Economics Working Paper, No. 23-12. Rome, FAO.	Background paper that is also part of a series (note that there are standard abbreviations for the flagship titles; in other cases, the entire title of the main publication would be inserted after *Background paper for*)
Pingault, N., Roshetko, J.M. & Meybeck, A., eds. 2021. *Asia-Pacific Forest Sector Outlook: Innovative forestry for a sustainable future – Youth contributions from Asia and the Pacific*. Bogor, Indonesia, CIFOR & Rome, FAO.	Multiple publishers in different locations
Schaller, G.B., Jinchu, H., Wenshi, P. & Jing, Z. 1985. *The Giant Pandas of Wolong*, p. 52. Chicago, Illinois, University of Chicago Press. Reproduced with permission.	Poster not within public domain (reproduced with permission); reference with notation
Ruane, J., Mba, C. & Xia, J., eds. 2022. *Proceedings of the Global Conference on Green Development of Seed Industries, 4–5 November 2021*. Rome, FAO. https://doi.org/10.4060/cc1220en	Proceedings
Tung, D.X. 2005. Smallholder poultry production in Vietnam: Marketing characteristics and strategies. Conference presentation at Does Poultry Reduce Poverty? A Need for Rethinking the Approaches, 30–31 August 2005. Copenhagen, Network for Smallholder Poultry Development.	Conference presentation

References	Format, comments
UN Geospatial. 2020a. BNDA_CTY [Shapefile]. New York, USA, UN.	Shapefile
UN Geospatial. 2020b. Map of the World. In: *United Nations*. New York, USA, UN. [Cited 25 November 2021]. https://www.un.org/geospatial/content/map-world-1	Web page
World Bank. 2019. Understanding poverty. In: *The World Bank*. Washington, DC. [Cited 3 April 2019]. https://www.worldbank.org/en/topic/poverty/overviewl	Web page

Box 12.2 _ Legal references

Prefer the author–date system when heavily referencing legal sources, as the references list can accommodate subcategories. It is possible to add Also available at: [URL] to legal sources cited from the original and also located in FAOLEX. When using Zotero, the URL can be inserted into the Zotero record, but the punctuation and Also available at will need to be added manually.
See Appendix 4 Installing and using Zotero for guidance specific to legal sources.

International instruments (binding)

African Charter on Human and Peoples' Rights. Nairobi, 27 June 1981. CAB/LEG/67/3 rev. 5 Also available at: https://faolex.fao.org/docs/pdf/mul-209984.pdf
Treaty establishing the European Economic Community (Treaty of Rome). Rome, 25 March 1957.

International instruments (non-binding)

Transforming Our World: The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development. United Nations General Assembly, 25 September 2015. UNGA A/RES/70/1.
United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (UNDRIP). United Nations General Assembly, 13 September 2007. UNGA A/RES/61/295.

Legal cases

Ashgar Leghari v. Federation of Pakistan. Lahore High Court, September 2015. W.P. No. 25501/2015.
State of the Netherlands v. Urgenda Foundation. District Court of The Hague, April 2015. The Supreme Court rejected an appeal on 20 December 2019.

National and supranational legislation

Kenya. *Microfinance Act*, 2012. Cap 493D.

Box 12.3 _ Referencing databases

Database template: **Author**. Year of last update. Name of database: Name of dataset OR Name of database. [Accessed on DD Month YYYY]. URL. Licence: CC Licence.

Use the phrase Accessed on when referring to databases and datasets in references. Database names may be italicized, as long as it is applied consistently.

All FAO databases have a CC-BY-4.0 Creative Commons licence. For non-FAO databases, check if they have a licence and if so, include it.

If only referring to one dataset within a database, cite the dataset, e.g. **FAO.** 2022. FAOSTAT: Crops and livestock products. [Accessed on 3 March 2021]. https://www.fao.org/faostat/en/#data/QCL. Licence: CC-BY-4.0.

When a database only has one dataset, cite the database, like RuLIS or AQUASTAT, e.g. **FAO.** 2020. RuLIS. [Accessed on 27 February 2024]. https://www.fao.org/in-action/rural-livelihoods-dataset-rulis/data-application/data/by-indicator/en. Licence: CC-BY-4.0.

When multiple datasets from within the same database have been sourced, cite the database, e.g. **FAO.** 2020. Global Forest Resources Assessment (FRA). [Accessed on 19 February 2024]. https://fra-data.fao.org/assessments/fra/2020. Licence: CC-BY-4.0.

Appendix 1
ONLINE EDITORIAL RESOURCES

For issues not addressed in "FAOSTYLE: English" please use the below resources.

Note that some of the links below are internal documents. If you are an external collaborator and require access to any of these resources, please ask your hiring manager.

Spelling and word usage

Oxford English Dictionary

Oxford Learner's Dictionary – choose "Search Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary" in the search bar

Terminology

FAO Term Portal – collection that includes terms and definitions related to the various topics covered by FAO in all six FAO languages (plus Italian and Latin for taxonomies)

UNTERM – the United Nations terminology database

IATE – the terminology database of the European Union

AGROVOC – the FAO thesaurus, which serves as a controlled vocabulary for indexing publications and datasets in agricultural science and technology

Style matters

FAOSTYLE for Arabic, Chinese, French, Russian, Spanish

Chicago Manual of Style

United Nations Editorial Manual

International Plant Protection Convention style guide

Time zone abbreviations

Language resources

Library of Congress transliteration tables

UN Disability-Inclusive Communications Guidelines

Country names and geographical designations

NOCS – Names of countries and territories database

M49 – Standard country or area codes for statistical use

Maps in FAO documents – Cheat sheet on correct map usage

Other

Practical implications of the ONE FAO approach for publications as set out in DG BULLETIN 2023/15

Appendix 2
LIST OF RECOMMENDED WORDS

For general spelling rules, please see 4 Spelling.

A

above-mentioned

accommodation *not* accommodations

acknowledgement *not* acknowledgment

addendum, pl. **addenda** not italicized

ad hoc not italicized

ad lib not italicized

advertise

advice (n.), **advise** (v.)

adviser *not* advisor, *but note* **advisory**

affect (v.) to have an effect on, cf. **effect**

afforestation where previous land type or use was not forestry

affranchise

aflatoxin

African swine fever *not* African Swine Fever

after-care, **after-effect**

afterwards (adv.) *not* afterward

ageing

age group

agenda, pl. **agendas**

agribusiness

agricultural sector *preferred to* agriculture sector

agriculturist *not* agriculturalist

agrifood

agro- compounds closed up except before i, e.g. agroecology, agroecosystem, agro-industry, agroforestry, agrometeorology, agrosilvicultural, agrosilvipastoral

air-dried (adj.), **air-dry** (v.)

airtight

alfalfa *not* Alfalfa

alga, pl. **algae**

alkaline, **alkalinization**

alley cropping

all-season (adj.)

alternate(ly) by turns, **alternative(ly)** presenting a choice between alternatives. An alternate method is one to be used every second time; an alternative method is one that can be chosen instead of some other method.

aluminium *not* aluminum

aman rice

amid *not* amidst

amino acid

among *not* amongst

analogue *not* analog

analyse *not* analyze

antenatal

antenna, pl. **antennae** (zool.), **antennas** (aerials)

anthelmintic

anti-erosion

antinutrient, **antinutritional**, **antipollution**

appendix, pl. **appendices** (books), **appendixes** (anat. or zool.)

aquaculture, **aquaculturist**

Arabian Gulf *avoid; use* **Persian Gulf**

armyworm

artefact *not* artifact

artisan (n.), **artisanal** (adj.)

Asia and the Pacific

assist + in + gerund or noun *not* assist + inf., e.g. They assist in training the farmers

asylum-seekers

audiocassette, **audiotape**, **audiovisual**

Australasia *avoid; use* **Oceania**

autumn *not* fall; lower case

awareness-raising (n.)

axle-hole

axletree

B

Bachelor of Arts degree (**BA**)

Bachelor of Science degree (**BSc**)

backcross (n., v.), **backlog**

back-reef

backscatter (radar term)

backup (n., adj.), **back up** (v.)

backward (adj.), **backwards** (adv.)

band-saw

bandwidth

baseline

basis, pl. **bases**

Bedouin

beehive

beekeeper, **beekeeping**

beeswax

behaviour *not* behavior

benchmark

benefited, **benefiting**

berseem (fodder crop) not capitalized

better production, better nutrition, a better environment, a better life (four betters)

biannual twice a year

biennial every second year

biennium, pl. **biennia** period of two years

bilateral

billion one thousand million

bimonthly twice a month or every two months – best to specify

bio- compounds closed up, except before some vowels, e.g. bio-available, bio-assay, *but* bioelectricity, bioenergy, bioinputs

biological diversity or **biodiversity** follow author's use

birth date

birthplace

birth rate

birth weight, *but* **birthweight** in *State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World* reports only

bivalve

biweekly twice a week or every two weeks – best to specify

black gram

blackleg (sheep and cattle disease)

black tongue (disease of dogs)

bluetongue (disease of sheep)

boatbuilder, **boatbuilding**, **boatmaker**, **boatmaking**, **boatyard**

boll-rot

boll weevil

bollworm

bookkeeping

borehole

boro

bottle-feed, **bottle-feeding**

bottleneck

breadbasket

breadfruit

breakdown (n.), **break down** (v.)

breakthrough (n.), **break through** (v.)

breastfed, breastfeed, **breastfeeding**

breastmilk

briquette, **briquetting**

broad bean *preferred to* fava bean

broadleaf (n.)

broadleaved

brood fish, **brood hen**

broodstock

brush fire

Brussels sprouts

bud rot

bud-take

budwood

buffalo, pl. **buffaloes**

buildup (n.), **build up** (v.)

built-in (adj.), **built-up** (adj.)

bureau, pl. **bureaus**

burn, **burnt** (past participle)

buses, **busing** *not* busses, bussing

bushfire

bushmeat

butterfat

bycatch

by-law

bypass

by-product

byte (computer term)

C

cacao virus

cadastral, **cadastre**

calibre *not* caliber

calorie *avoid*; *use* **kilocalorie** (abbrev. **kcal**) – when not used as a measure, **food energy** preferred, e.g. Groundnuts can contribute food energy to a diet, *not* Groundnuts can contribute calories …

camel-hair

can, **canning** *or* **tin**, **tinning** (be consistent)

cantaloupe

capacity building (n.), **capacity-building** (adj.)

carryover (n., adj.), **carry over** (v.)

case study

cash crop (n., v.)

cash flow

cashew nut

castor seed *preferred to* castor bean

catalogue *not* catalog

cattle herd of cattle, e.g. 12 head of cattle, *not* 12 cattle

cattle breeder, **cattle feed**, **cattle hide** (*but* **cowhide**), **cattle owner**, *but* **cattle-ranching**

Celsius, **centigrade** (abbrev. **C**) two names for the same system of measuring temperature. Always use Celsius, *not* Fahrenheit. The formulae for converting from Fahrenheit to centigrade and vice versa are: $F = [(9 \times C) \div 5] + 32$; $C = 5(F - 32) \div 9$. Note that temperatures are written with a non-breaking space between the number and the unit, e.g. 35 °C

central, Central see 8 Capitalization

centre (n., v.) *not* center

centrepiece

cf. (abbrev.) compare

chainsaw

chalkboard

changeover (n.), **change over** (v.)

channelled, **channelling**

check dam

checklist

checkup (n.), **check** (v.)

cheese-maker, **cheese-making**

cheque *not* check (mode of payment)

chickpea

child-bearing (adj.)

childbirth

child care

chilli, **chillies** or **chili**, **chilies** follow author's use

clamorous

clamour

classmate, **classroom**

clayey

clear-cutting (n.), **clear-cut** (adj.) evident, **clear-cut** (v.) to cut all trees in a stand

clear-eyed

clearfell, **clearfelling**

clear-headed

clearinghouse

clear-out (n.), **clear out** (v.)

clear-sighted

climate change (n.), **climate-change** (adj.)

climate-smart

clipboard

clone selection *not* clonal selection

co- most compounds hyphenated

coal mining

coco name of a palm tree, **coconut** seed of the palm tree

cocoa bean *not* cacao bean

cold chain, **cold store**, **cold storage**

colour, **discolour**, **colourable**, *but note* **coloration** and **decoloration**

colourless

combated, **combating**

commodity group price

community-driven (adj.)

complement something that completes, enhances or improves

compliment expression of praise

comprise *not* comprised of, e.g. the strategy comprises three elements

computer terms many ordinary English words have a specific computer sense, e.g. access (v.), add-in (n., adj.), database, data file, debug, format (formatting, formatter), hard copy, hard code, hard-wired, input (v.), log on (v.), online, offline, program (programming, programmer), real time (n.), real-time (adj.)

connection *not* connexion

cont. (abbrev.) continued

continual going on for a long time, recurring at intervals, seeming never to come to an end

continuous uninterrupted

convenor *not* convener

cooperate, **cooperation**, **cooperative**

co-opt

coordinate, **coordination**

corn *use* **maize**, **grain** or **cereal**, depending on the particular case, *but* **corn on the cob**, **sweet corn**

cornerstone

corrigendum, pl. **corrigenda**

cost-effectiveness (n.), **cost-effective** (adj.)

cost-of-illness (adj.)

cottonseed, **cottonseed oil**

council (n.) administrative body

councillor council member

counsel (n., v.) advice, to advise

counsellor adviser

counter- compounds closed up, e.g. counteract, counterpart, counterproductive

country-level (adj.)

COVID-19 correct usage: Prices fell due to the COVID-19 pandemic, *but* COVID-19 infection rates increased by 10 percent

cowhide, **cowpea**

cow's milk as opposed to breastmilk; **cow milk** as a commodity (also **goat milk**)

crisis, pl. **crises**

criss-cross

criterion, pl. **criteria**

cropland

cross-breed (n., v.), **cross-breeding**, **cross-bred** (adj.)

cross-check, **cross-fertilization**, **cross-pollination**, **cross-reference**, **cross-section**

curriculum, pl. **curricula**

cutback (n.), **cut back** (v.)

cutoff (n.), **cut off** (v.)

D

data may be plural or singular (be consistent). The rarely found **datum** (as in datum line) is always singular

databank, database, dataset, **datasheet**, *but* **data file**

date palm

day care (n., adj.)

day labourer

day length (n.)

daylight, **daytime**

day-to-day (adj.), *but* **from day to day**

death rate

debug (computer term)

decision support (n.), **decision-support** (adj.)

deep-freeze, **deep-frozen**

deep-sea fishing

de- compounds closed up, except when followed by "e", e.g. de-escalate

de facto not italicized

defence *not* defense

deflection *not* deflexion

deforest, **deforestation**

deleafing

demand-driven (adj.)

dendro-energy wood-based energy

dependant (n.), **dependent** (adj.)

desert locust *not* Desert Locust

despatch *use* **dispatch**

developing countries *not* Third World *or* underdeveloped countries

deworm

dialogue *not* dialog

diameter *not* diametre

diamondback moth

dieback (n.), **die back** (v.)

digester, e.g. biogas digester

dipnet

disc (all uses except computers, *see* disk)

discreet restrained in speech and behaviour

discrete individually distinct, separate

disk (computers only)

doctorate (PhD)

double-duty

downtime, **downtrend, downturn**

downward (adj.), **downwards** (adv.)

draught for traction (as in draught animals)

drawback (n.), **draw back** (v.)

drier (n., adj.) or **dryer** (n.) follow author's use

driftnet

drinking water

drop-off (n.), **drop off** (v.)

dryland farming (n.)

drylands (n.), **dryland** (adj.)

dry rot

due and **owing** avoid unless used as financial terms. It is better to substitute **result from**, **because**, etc., e.g. Crop failure resulted from drought, or The crops failed because of drought

dyke *not* dike

E

earthwork

East Coast fever

east, eastern, East, Eastern see 8 Capitalization

eastward (adj.), **eastwards** (adv.)

echograph

echo sounder, **echo sounding**

eco- compounds closed up, e.g. ecoclimate,
but note eco-friendly (adj.)

e-commerce

economic relating to the science of economics or the economy in general, **economical**, characterized by thrift or representing good value for money

effect (v.) *not* effectuate; to bring about; not to be confused with **affect**

e-learning, *but note* **FAO elearning Academy**

email *not* e-mail

empanel, **empanelled**

end use, **end user**

end-point

end product

energy-dense (adj.)

energy-sufficient diet

enquire, **enquiry** *not* inquire, inquiry

enrol, **enrolled**, **enrolment**

ensilage, **silage** silage is the product of the process of ensilage

ensure to make sure, not to be used for **insure**

equalled, **equalling**

equator, equatorial, Equatorial see 8 Capitalization

erodible

erratum, pl. **errata**

et al. italicized

etc. not italicized

et seq. italicized

evapotranspiration

ex ante italicized

explant

ex post, ***ex post facto*** italicized

ex situ italicized

extra- compounds closed up, except when followed by "a" or a proper noun, e.g. extra-atmospheric, extra-Community trade

F

factsheet

falloff (n.)

fan-leaf

farmer-managed (adj.)

farm gate

farmhand, farmhouse, **farmland**

farm worker

farmyard

farther, **further** use farther for literal distances, further for everything else, e.g. We must travel two kilometres farther, but I can go no further with this project.

fast food (n.) **fastfood** (adj.)

feedback, **feedlot**

feedgrain(s) and **feedstuffs** for animal consumption, **foodgrains** and **foodstuffs** for human consumption

fermenter

ferruginous *not* ferrugineous

fewer use for countable items, **less** for amounts, e.g. fewer cows, less milk

fibre

fibreboard, **fibreglass**

fieldbook

field guide

field test (n.), **field-test** (v.)

field trial

fieldwork, **field worker**

filmstrip

filter paper

fine tuning (n.), **fine-tune** (v.)

finfish(es)

finger millet

firebreak

fire crew

firefighter

firewood *avoid*; *use* **fuelwood**

First World *avoid*; *use* **industrialized countries**

first, **second**, etc. *not* firstly, secondly, etc.

first aid, **first-aid kit**

first-hand, **second-hand**, **third-hand** ... (adj.), *but* **at first hand**

first-rate (adj.)

fish, pl. **fish** unless referring to more than one species of fish

fish culture

fish farm, **fish farming**, **fish farmer**

fisher *not* fisherman

fishing gear, **fishing tackle**

fish-liver oil

fishmeal, **fishnet**

fish oil, **fish pond**, **fish seed**, **fish stocks**

flip chart

floodgate, **floodplain, floodwall, floodwater**

flood tide

flowchart

focused, **focuses**, **focusing**

foetal

-fold compounds closed up, e.g. twofold, twentyfold

follow-up (adj., n), **follow up** (v.)

food balance sheet abbrev. **(FBS)**

food-based dietary guidelines abbrev. **(FBDGs)**

foodborne preferred; **food-borne** also accepted

food crops *not* foodcrops

food for work (n.), **food-for-work** (adj.)

foodgrain(s) (for human consumption), **feedgrain(s)** (for animal consumption)

food insecure (n.); **food-insecure** (adj.)

food-processing (adj.)

food security

foodstuff(s), **feedstuff(s)** as above

foot-and-mouth disease (abbrev. **FMD**)

forego to precede, *but* **forgo** to go without

forestland

forest tree

forklift

format, **formatted**, **formatting**, **formatter**

formula, pl. **formulae** (math., chem.) *but* **formulas** (methods)

forum, pl. **fora**

foreword (of book)

forward (adj., v.), **forwards** (adv.)

four betters *see* **better production** ... etc.

-free compounds hyphenated, e.g. disease-free, germ-free

freeze-dried, **freeze-drier**, **freeze-dry**

freshwater (n., adj.)

front-of-pack (adj.)

fruit fly

fruit-set (n.), **set fruit** (v.)

fruit tree

fuelwood *not* firewood

fulfil, **fulfillable**, **fulfilled**, **fulfiller**, **fulfilling**, **fulfilment**

full-cost (adj.)

full-scale (adj.), *but* **at full scale**

full time (n., adv.) **full-time** (adj.),

fundraiser (n.), **fundraising** (n., adj.) *but* **raise funds** (v.)

further *see* **farther**

G

gene bank preferred; **genebank** also accepted

gene flow, **gene pool**

geoprobe, **geothermic**

germ cell, **germ line**

germplasm

gigabyte (abbrev. **GB**)

gillnet

Global South

glycerine *not* glycerin

goat pox

goatskin

grainfed

gram (abbrev. **g**) *not* gramme

grassroots (n., adj.)

gravelled

green belt, **green revolution**

greenhouse *not* glasshouse

greenhouse gas abbrev. **(GHG)**

grey *not* gray

groundcover

ground nut (*Apios americana*)

groundnut or peanut (*Apios hypogaea*)

ground rent

ground truthing

groundwater, **groundwork**

guestimate *avoid*; **guess** or **estimate** preferred

guidebook, **guidelines**

guinea fowl, **guinea pig**

H

handbook

hand-delivered

handicraft (n.), **handcraft** (v.)

hand in hand, *but* **Hand-in-Hand Initiative**

handline (fishing term)

handout

hand-pollination (n.), **hand-pollinate** (v.)

handsaw

hand sprayer (n.), **hand-spray** (v.)

hand tools, **hand weeding**

hardback

hardcover

hardpan (soil term)

hard-wired (computer term)

hazelnut

headquarters *not* HQ

health care

health services *not* healthcare services

heartwood

heat-resistant

heavy-duty (adj.)

hectare (abbrev. **ha**)

herder *not* herdsman

herdowner

heterogeneous composed of parts of different kinds; mixed

heterogenous having origin in an outside source

high-yielding varieties (abbrev. **HYVs**)

hillside, **hilltop**

historic, **historical** not interchangeable. A historic event (NB *not* an historic event) is one that makes history, even if recent; a historical event is one that occurred in the past and has been recorded by historians

home care

homegrown, **homemade**

home page

homespun

homogeneous consisting of parts of the same kind

homogenous corresponding in structure because of common origin

honey bee

honeycomb, **honeydew**

honorary, **honour**, **honourable**

hoof, pl. **hooves**

-hopper compounds closed up, e.g. grasshopper, leafhopper, planthopper, ricehopper

horse pox

horticulturist

hot spot

households

hydro- compounds closed up

I

ibid. not italicized

idem not italicized

i.e. not italicized, not followed by a comma

ill- hyphenate compounds used as adjectives, e.g. ill-gotten, ill-natured, ill-omened

immunoassay

impact (n.), should not be used as a verb

imperilled

imprest fund or account

inbred, **inbreeding**

inbuilt

income-earning (adj.)

in-country

in-depth

index, pl. **indexes** (books), **indices** (when technical or statistical)

Indigenous Peoples capitalize both words

infra-axillary

infrared (adj.)

infrastructure

in-house

innovate

inoculate

inquire, inquiry *use* **enquire**, **enquiry**

in-service

in situ italicized

install, **installation**, **instalment**

instil

insure for insurance policies only (cf. **ensure**)

in vitro italicized

in vivo italicized

inter- compounds closed up, e.g. interaction, interconnectivity, interdepartmental, intergenerational, intergovernmental, interregional, interrelated, intersectoral (preferred to cross-sectoral), intertemporal, *but note* inter-country

inter alia italicized

intern (n., v.) *not* interne

internet

intra- compounds closed up, except before a vowel, *but note* intra-country

intranet

inward (adj.), **inwards** (adv.)

J

Jr (abbrev.) not preceded by a comma and not followed by a full stop, e.g. John Jones Jr

judgement (judgment [law] – a judge or court's formal ruling)

K

kat *not* khat *or* qat; an evergreen shrub of the Near East

kharif summer growing season in parts of Near East and South Asia (opposite of **rabi**)

kilobyte (abbrev. **KB**), computer term

kilocalorie (abbrev. **kcal**) preferred to calorie as a measure of food energy

kilogram (abbrev. **kg**) *not* kilogramme

kilometre (abbrev. **km**) *not* kilometer

knowledgeable

kumquat *not* cumquat

L

labelled, **labelling**

laborious

labour

labour force

labour-intensive

labourer

laissez-passer italicized

lakh *not* lac (Anglo-Indian term meaning one hundred thousand, used for rupees)

lambskin, **lambswool**

landfill, **landform**

landholder, **landholding**

landlocked, *but note* Land Locked Developing Countries

landmark

landmass, **landmine**

landowner, **landownership**

land-poor

landrace, **landslide**

land use, **land-use planning**

large scale (n.), **large-scale** (adj.)

lastly *avoid*

layout (n.), **lay out** (v.)

lead (n., pres. v.), **led** (past, past part.)

lead time

leaf blight, **leaf curl**

leafhopper, **leafminer**

leaf roll

leaf spot disease, **leaf spotting**

learned *not* learnt

leaseholder

least-cost (adj.)

least developed countries (abbrev. **LDCs**)

lend (v.), *but* **loan** (n.)

liaise

licence (n.), **license** (v.)

licensee, **licensor**

life cycle (n.), **life-cycle** (adj).

lifelong

life-saving

lifespan

lifestyle, **lifetime**

-like compounds usually hyphenated, e.g. business-like, *but note* **lifelike**

line drawing

liquefaction, **liquefy**

litchi *not* lichee, lychee, lichi

litre *not* liter

live weight (n.)

log-on (adj.), **log on** (v.)

longhorn

long-lasting

longline

longstanding (adj.)

long term (n.), **long-term** (adj.)

lookout (n.)

loose-leaf (adj.)

lower-bound (adj.)

lower-middle-income (adj.)

lowest-cost (adj.)

M

M&E (abbrev.) monitoring and evaluation

macro- all compounds closed up, e.g. macroeconomic

maize meal, **maize oil**

mango, pl. **mangoes**

Masai *or* **Maasai** follow author's use

marketplace

mark-up (n.)

mass media

Master of Arts degree (MA), *but* master's degree

Master of Science degree (MSc), *but* master's degree

maximum, pl. **maxima**

meagre *not* meager

mealybug

medical terms use lower case for names of diseases, syndromes, tests, etc., except for proper names contained therein (Hodgkin's disease, Wasserman test). Names of diseases deriving from infectious organisms should be lower case and roman, e.g. trichinosis

medium term (n.), **medium-term** (adj.)

megabyte (abbrev. **MB**)

member countries *avoid* with reference to FAO

Member Nations

Members as in FAO Members

Member States *avoid* with reference to FAO

memorandum, pl. **memoranda**

merchandise (n., v.)

meter object that measures, **metre** unit of measure

micro- compounds usually closed up, e.g. microeconomics

mid- compounds: mid-1980s, mid-year, mid-point, mid-term, *but* midday, midnight, midsummer, midway, midweek

middle age (n.), **middle-aged** (adj.)

Middle East *use* **Near East** (except in MINEADEP and other cases when specifically required)

middle-sized *use* **medium-sized**

middleman *use* **intermediary**

midway (n., adj.)

millennium, pl. **millennia**

mini- compounds closed up, e.g. minibus, minicassette

minimum, pl. **minima**

misadvice (n.), **misadvise** (v.)

mollusc *not* mollusk

mono- compounds closed up except when followed by a vowel, e.g. mono-unsaturated

mortise *not* mortice

mosquito-borne

motorcycle, **motorcyclist**

motor-driven

motor nerve, **motor spirit**, **motor vehicle**

mould (n., v.) *not* mold

mouldboard

moulder

moulding

moult (v.) *not* molt

movable

mucus (n.), **mucous** (adj.)

multi- compounds closed up unless followed by a vowel

multinational *see* **transnational**

mung bean

Muslim *not* Moslem

N

net-buyers (n.)

newsletter

night-time

non- compounds usually hyphenated, *but note* **nonconformity**

no one

north, **northeast**, **northeastern**, **northern**, **North**, **Northeast**, **Northeastern**, **Northern** *see* 8 Capitalization

north temperate zone

northward (adj.), **northwards** (adv.)

northwest, **northwestern** *see* **north**, *but note* North-West Frontier Province, Pakistan

notebook

noticeable

no-till (adj.) **farming**

nutrient-adequate (adj.)

nutrient-dense (adj.)

nutrition adequate diet

nutrition-poor (adj.)

nutrition-sensitive (adj.)

nutritious foods

nut-tree

O

ochre

odoriferous

odorous, **odour**, **odourless**

off-farm (adj.)

offence *but note* **offensive**

offline

off-season

offset, **offshoot**, **offshore**

offsite

off-type non-standard plant variety

oilcake, **oilcrop**, **oilmeal**

oil palm

oilseed

on-farm (adj.)

ongoing (adj.) no hyphen

online

onshore

onsite

onward (adj.), **onwards** (adv.)

op cit. not italicized

organize, **organization with** 'z' unless part of a name that uses 's', e.g. Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development

orient *not* orientate

out- compounds closed up

outside *not* outside of

outward (adj.), **outwards** (adv.)

over- compounds usually closed up

owing *see* **due**

P

paddy rice

paddy field

palm oil

pan- if the second part of the compound is lower case, close up, e.g. pantheism; otherwise hyphenate, e.g. pan-American, pan-Germanism, pan-Hellenic, pan-Slavism

papaw use for *Asimina triloba* only

papaya use for *Carica papaya* only

paperback

para- compounds closed up

parallel, **paralleled**

particle board

part-time (adj.), **part time** (adv.)

pastureland

payoff (n.)

peacekeeping

peanut or **groundnut** use for *Arachis hypogaea*

peatland(s)

peatmoss

pedagogue

per annum not italicized

per capita preferred to per caput; not italicized

percent *not* per cent; use % only in figures and tables, e.g. 3% (no space)

per diem not italicized

peri-urban

Persian *avoid*; **Iranian** or **of the Islamic Republic of Iran** preferred

Persian Gulf standard geographical designation for the body of water lying between the Arabian Peninsula and the Islamic Republic of Iran; however, in documents, publications or statements emanating from a Member Government or intergovernmental organization, the original designation should be retained

person-day

per-unit (adj.)

Petri dish

PhD Doctor of Philosophy

phosphorus (n.) the element, **phosphorous** (adj.) containing phosphorus

photo- compounds closed up, e.g. photoelectric, photocopier (n.), photocopy (n., v.)

phyto- compounds closed up

piece rate (n.), **piece-rate** (adj.)

piecework

pigeon pea

pig meat

pigskin

pigsty, (pl.) **pigsties**

pimento, (pl.) **pimentos**

pipeline

pisciculture

plant- and animal-sourced (adj.)

plant-based (adj.)

plant-forward (adj.)

planthopper

plateau, pl. **plateaus** *not* plateaux

plough *not* plow

pod borer

policymaker, **policymaking**

poly- compounds closed up, e.g. polyunsaturated

polyethylene *not* polythene

post- compounds usually closed up except where confusion might arise, e.g. **post-harvest** or when followed by "t", e.g. post-translational

power-saw

p. referring to one specific page, **pp.** referring to a series of pages, e.g. p. 40, pp. 40–42

practice (n.), **practise** (v.)

pre- compounds closed up except where confusion might arise, e.g. pre-empt, pre-set, pre-test, pre-war

prescribe to recommend or impose a practice, etc.

pretence *not* pretense

prevalence

preventive *not* preventative

price fixing

prima facie not italicized

printout (n.), **print out** (v.)

print run

privilege

proactive

problematic *not* problematical

pro forma

program, **programmer** (computer terms)

programme for all non-computer uses (except where part of a proper name)

-proof compounds usually closed up *but note* acid-proof, failure-proof, gas-proof

propel, **propeller**

prophecy (n.), **prophesy** (v.)

prorate

proscribe to prevent or ban a practice, etc.

protein-rich (adj.)

proved has (been) proved, *but* **proven** ability or case

prototype

provitamin A

pure-bred (n., adj.)

purse seine (n.), **purse-seine** (v.)

Q

quasi avoid where possible; if necessary to use, hyphenate, e.g. quasi-official

R

R&D (abbrev.) research and development

rabi winter growing season in parts of Near East and South Asia (opposite of **kharif**)

rachis, pl. **rachides**

rainfall, **rainfed**

rainforest

rainstorm, **rainwater**

-raising compounds hyphenated, e.g. cattle-raising

rangeland

rapeseed oil

re- compounds closed up except when followed by "e" or where necessary to distinguish meaning, e.g. re-count, re-sort, re-cover, re-form

real time (n.), **real-time** (adj.)

record-keeping

recur, **recurrence** *not* reoccur *or* reoccurrence

reduced impact logging *not* reduced-impact logging

reforestation *not* reafforestation

regime no accent

regrettable

religions, **religious groups** capitalize the names of religions, churches and religious groups, but do not capitalize the word church (or order, movement, heresy, etc.), e.g. the Roman Catholic church; for places of worship, capitalize the word church, temple, mosque, etc. only if it is part of the name of the building or place

remote sensing

revoke *but* **revocable**

rhizogenesis *not* rhyzogenesis

rights holder, pl. **rights holders**

rigour, rigorous

ringbark (v.)

ringspot

riverbank, **riverbed**, **riverside**

roadside

root crop

root-knot nematode

root rot

rootstock

round table (n.), **round-table** (adj.)

roundwood

rumour *not* rumor

runoff

ryegrass

S

Sahara the Sahara, *not* the Sahara Desert

Sahel, the

Sahelian zone

saltbush

salt-lick

saltwater (n., adj.)

sandbank

sand dune

sandstorm

sapwood

savannah *not* savanna

sawdust, **sawlogs**, **sawmill**

sawntimber, **sawnwood**

sawpit, **sawtimber**

scaling up

sceptical *not* skeptical

schoolbooks

schoolchildren

school-leaver, **school-leaving**

schoolteacher

scoop net

seabed, **seafloor**

sea freight (n.), **sea-freight** (adj.)

sea level (n.), **sea-level** (adj.)

sea moss

sea wall

seawater

Second World War *not* World War II

sectoral *not* sectorial

seed bank, **seed bed**

seed-borne, **seed-coat**

seed lot

self- compounds all hyphenated

semi-arid

serosurveillance

setback (n.), **set back** (v.)

sewing machine

shade house *not* shadehouse

sharecropper, **sharecropping**

sheep meat, **sheep pox**

sheepskin

shelf-life

shelterbelt

shortfall

shorthorn

short-lived

short term (n.), **short-term** (adj.)

short wave (n.), **short-wave** (adj.)

shutdown (n.), **shut-down** (adj.), **shut down** (v.)

side-effect

sideline

SIDS see Small Island Developing States

silage, **ensilage** silage is the product of the process of ensilage

silkworm

silvi- compounds closed up unless followed by a vowel

sirocco, pl. **siroccos**

sizeable

siphon *not* syphon

skilful *not* skillful

skimmed milk, **skim milk** follow author's use

-skin compounds closed up, e.g. goatskin

slaughterhouse

slowdown (n.), **slow down** (v.)

smallholder, **smallholding**

Small Island Developing States (abbrev. **SIDS**) all upper case when referring to the group, all lower case when referring to a single state (**small island developing state**)

small scale (n.), **small-scale** (adj.)

smoulder *not* smolder

social costs *not* societal costs

socio- compounds usually closed up

socioeconomic

sociometric, **sociometry**

soft cover

soil-borne

soja bean *avoid*; *use* **soybean**

south, **southeast**, **southeastern**, **southern**, **South**, **Southeast**, **Southeastern**, **Southern** *see* 8 Capitalization, *but* **South-eastern Asia** in *State of Food Security and Nutrition* reports only

south temperate zone

southward (adj.), **southwards** (adv.)

southwest, **southwestern** *see* **south**

soybean *not* soyabean or soja bean

speciality *not* specialty

spectre *not* specter

spelled *not* spelt

spillover (n.), **spill over** (v.)

spreadsheet

St *not* St. (contraction for Saint)

stall-feed, **stall-feeding**

stalk borer

standby (n.), **stand by** (v.)

staple-based diet

staple food

starting-point

state lower case when referring generally to nations or divisions of a nation; upper case when a specific state is named, e.g. State of New York; *but* state-owned enterprise, head of state

statewide

stationary not moving; **stationery** paper, pens, etc.

status quo not italicized

stem borer, **stem rot**

stockbreeder

stock owners

stockpile

stone-fruit

stopgap

storehouse, **storeroom**

storey, pl. **storeys** preferred spelling for floor(s) of a building

stratum, pl. **strata**

sub- compounds closed up unless followed by "b", e.g. **sub-basin**; *note* **sub-Saharan**

subject matter

sugar beet (n.), **sugarbeet** (adj.)

sugar cane (n.), **sugarcane** (adj.)

sugar-gum

sugar refinery

sugar-sweetened beverages

sulphur *not* sulfur

sun-dried (adj.), **sun dry** (v.)

sunflower seed (n.), **sunflower-seed** (adj.)

supersede *never* supercede

supply-driven

symposium, pl. **symposia**

synthesis, pl. **syntheses**

syphon *use* **siphon**

T

takeoff (n.), **take off** (v.)

takeover (n.), **take over** (v.)

tap-root, **tap-water**

tape recorder (n.), **tape-record** (v.)

target (v.), **targeted** (past part.)

taskforce

teamwork

testcross (n., v.)

test run

test-tube

thiamine *not* thiamin

Third World *use* **developing countries**

tick-borne

timberland, **timberline**

time frame, **time lag**, **time limit**

time-saving

timescale, **time series**

timetable

tiro *not* tyro

titration, **titre**

tobacco, pl. **tobaccos**

tonne refers to metric tonne; avoid ton unless referring to shipping vessel tons

toolkit

top-down (adj.)

top-dressing (n.), **top-dress** (v.)

top-graft

topsoil

totalled, **totalling**

towards *not* **toward**

tradable

trade-off

trafficking, **trafficker**

trans- compounds closed up

transferring

transhumance

transnational the correct word for a corporation that operates across international boundaries is transnational, *not* multinational, which implies ownership by more than one nationality

transship, **transshipment**

travelled, **traveller**

trawl-line

trawlnet

treatise

tree fruit, **tree line**

trifurcate

tri-junction

troubleshoot, **troubleshooter**

trypanoprophylactic *not* trypano-preventive

trypanosomosis *not* trypanosomiasis

trypanotolerance, **trypanotolerant**

tsetse fly

tubewell

turnaround

turnover

tyre (n.) *not* tire

U

ultra- compounds generally closed up, e.g. **ultrasonic**, **ultraviolet**

under- compounds generally closed up unless followed by "r", e.g. **under-represented**

understorey

underway

update (n.), **up-to-date** (adj.), *but* **bring up to date** (v.)

upgrade, **upland**

upper-middle-income (adj.)

up-river

uproot, **uprooted**

upward (adj.), **upwards** (adv.)

usable *not* useable

V

value added (n.), **value-added** (adj.)

vaporific, **vaporiform**, **vaporimeter**

vaporize

vaporous, **vapour** *not* vapor

vapour burner

vector-borne

vein banding, **vein clearing**

veldt

versus (abbrev. **vs**) not italicized; (abbrev. *v.* for legal cases) italicized

veterinarian

vice versa not italicized

vicuña *not* vicuna

video camera

videocassette

video display

video recorder

videotape

Viet Nam *but* **Vietnamese**

viewfinder

viewpoint

vigorous, **vigour**

W

wadi not italicized

wage-earner

-ward (adj.), **-wards** (adv.), e.g. an upward movement, moving upwards

Washington, **DC**

wastewater

waterbird, **waterbody**

waterborne preferred; **water-borne** also accepted

water buffalo

watercourse, **waterfall**

water-flea

waterfowl

water-hole

water level (n.), **water-level** (adj.)

waterline

watermark

watermelon

water-power

waterproof

watershed

water-soluble

water supply (n.), **water-supply** (adj.)

water table (n.), **water-table** (adj.)

watertight

water-tower

waterway

water-weed

wavelength

webworm

website

weed-killer

weekday, **weekend**

well-being

wellwater

west, **western**, **West**, **Western** *see* 8 Capitalization

wetlands

while *not* whilst

whiteboard, **whitefly**

wholemeal

-wide compounds: close up countrywide, nationwide, worldwide; hyphenate economy-wide, island-wide, organization-wide, system-wide

wide-ranging, **wide-reaching**

widescale (adj.), *but* **on a wide scale**

widespread

wildland, **wildlife**

windbreak (n.)

wind-row

-wise compounds – avoid except in words such as clockwise

-wood compounds closed up, e.g. brushwood, budwood, cordwood, fuelwood, hardwood, sawnwood

wood ash

woodcutter, **woodfuel**, **woodlot**

wood stove

woodwork

woollen *not* woolen

workday, **workbench**, **workforce**, **workload**

worker *not* workman

workplace

workplan

workroom, **worksheet**, **workshop**

work site

workstation, **worktable**

World Wide Web

Y

yearbook

year-end (adj.), **year-long** (adj.), **year-round** (adj.)

yoghurt

Z

zero-grazing

zeros *not* zeroes

Appendix 3
USEFUL SHORTCUTS AND FUNCTIONS IN MICROSOFT WORD

SHORTCUT/ FUNCTION	TOOLBAR[a]	WINDOWS OS	MAC OS (if different)
En-dash	Insert > Symbol > More Symbols > Special Character	Ctrl+ Minus	Option+ Hyphen
Non-breaking hyphen	Insert > Symbol > More Symbols > Special Character	Ctrl+Shift +Hyphen	Command+ Shift+ Hyphen
Non-breaking space	Insert > Symbol > More Symbols > Special Character	Ctrl+Shift +Space	
Ellipsis	Insert > Symbol > More Symbols > Special Character	Alt+Ctrl+.	
Mathematical symbols (for frequent use)	File > Options > Proofing > Auto Correct Options; then check "Use Math Auto Correct rules outside of math regions" > OK		
Multiplication sign	Insert > Symbol > More Symbols > Mathematical Operators		
Minus symbol	Insert > Symbol > More Symbols > Mathematical Operators		
Equations	Insert > Equation		
Flesch Reading Ease and Flesch–Kincaid Grade Level	File > Options; then in the pop-up: Proofing > Show Readability Statistics > OK To view the results: Review > Spelling and Grammar; then in the sidebar > Insights		
Default Language (English [United Kingdom])	File > Options; then in the in pop-up > Language > English (United Kingdom) under "Office authoring language and proofing" > Set as preferred > OK	Status bar (bottom of page)	

[a] These instructions are based on Microsoft Word for Microsoft 365 MSO (Version 2401).

Appendix 4
INSTALLING AND USING ZOTERO

Zotero is a free, open-source tool to collect, organize, annotate, cite and share research. Within FAO, Zotero is managed by colleagues who have created two citation styles based on FAOSTYLE.[a] These are called **Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations**, used for the author–date referencing system, and **Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (numeric)**, used for the endnote referencing system.

Zotero documentation provides video tutorials for using Zotero.

A4.1 Installation

Install Zotero:

1. From FAO headquarters or an FAO laptop, open the Software Center application and search for "Zotero". If using a personal computer, download directly from Zotero.
2. Follow the instructions in the download wizard to install the software. Registration is recommended but not required.
3. To format citations automatically in FAOSTYLE, you also need to install the Zotero Word Processor Plugin and one of the FAO citation styles. It is highly recommended to install the Zotero Connector for browsers.

Install Zotero Word Processor Plugin:

1. The add-in should be installed automatically. Launch Zotero and, in the menu, go to Tools -> Add-ons. "Zotero Word for Windows Integration" should appear in the list of extensions with a button "Disable" next to it.
2. To confirm, open Microsoft Word. A new Zotero tab should appear in the ribbon.

Install Zotero Connector for browsers:

1. Launch Zotero and, in the menu, go to Tools -> Install Browser Connector.
2. A web page will appear in the browser. Follow the instructions.

Note that the Zotero Connector may not work with Internet Explorer.

Install FAO citation style(s):

1. Launch Zotero and, in the menu, go to Edit -> Preferences.
2. Click the "Cite" button. The "Styles" tab should open by default.
3. Click the "Get additional styles" link on the bottom left of the "Style Manager" frame. It will take you to the Zotero Style Repository.
4. Type "FAO" in the search bar.

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[a] OCCP is especially grateful to Bin Liu, Nutrition and Food Systems Officer (ESN), for creating, testing and amending the FAO citation style files.

5. Click the link “Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations” to download the file for the author–date referencing system or the link “Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (numeric)” to download the file for the endnote referencing system.
6. The file will automatically download to Zotero. Click “OK” to exit the window or click “Get additional styles” again to download the other FAO citation style file.

Citation style files can also be accessed directly via the Zotero Style Repository.

Once the style files have been downloaded, any updates to them will be made automatically when Zotero is relaunched.

Box A4.1 _ Three easy ways to save sources to a Zotero library

Each of these options will automatically create a new item in your library with the available metadata. If necessary, you can then make manual changes to the item.

1. Click “Save to Zotero” in the Zotero Connector browser extension.
2. Use the “Export citation” function provided by a webpage (if available).
3. Use Zotero’s built-in function “Add items by identifier” to paste a DOI, ISBN or another identifier.

A4.2 Legal sources

1. Prefer the author–date system and map the citation elements onto the following item types and fields.

- For legal cases, select **case**, and complete the following fields with source information**:**

  Case name = Name v. Name
  Court = Court name
  Date decided = Date (e.g. 2024-03-06 or 6 Mar 2024 or Mar 6, 2024)
  Docket number and/or reporter volume = Codes

- For international instruments (international or regional, binding or non-binding), select **bill**, and complete the following fields with source information:

  Title = Full name
  Short title = Alternative name or abbreviation (will appear in brackets in the bibliography)
  Legislative body = Agency
  Extra = “Place: ” + place name (e.g. Place: Niger)
  Date = Date (e.g. 2024-03-06 or 6 Mar 2024 or Mar 6, 2024)
  Bill number = Codes

- For national and supranational legislation, select **statute**, and complete the following fields with source information:

Author = Country or region, etc.
Name of act = Name of legislation
Date enacted = Date (e.g. 2024-03-06 or 6 Mar 2024 or Mar 6 2024)
Public law number = Codes
URL = URL

2. When using the author–date system, the in-text citation created by Zotero will include the content from the **Short Title** field, not the **Title** field. This can be updated manually if the full title is preferred. For example, (*Treaty of Rome*, 1957) is the in-text citation Zotero provides, which corresponds to the bibliographic entry:
Treaty establishing the European Economic Community (*Treaty of Rome*). Rome, 25 March 1957. Also available at: https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=LEGISSUM%3Axy0023

3. When building bibliographic lists that include legal references, consider the following points.
   - When using the author-date system, the bibliography generated by Zotero for the References section will be automatically sorted by source type:
     1. all non-legal materials, sorted alphabetically by author, then ascending date;
     2. then bills, sorted alphabetically by title;
     3. then cases, sorted alphabetically by title; and
     4. then statutes, sorted alphabetically by author, then by ascending date.
     The author should add subtitles such as Literature and databases, Legal cases, International instruments or National legislation to the References section to clarify how the list is organized.
   - Statutes sourced from databases such as FAOLEX are automatically set up to indicate that they are "also available at" the inserted web address. This can be manually revised in the publication, if needed, after the bibliography has been created. Also available at: [URL] can be manually added to cases and bills, if needed.

A4.3 Database sources

1. For both databases and datasets, select **dataset**, and complete the following fields:

   Title = Dataset name [Optional]
   Author = Corporate author name
   Date = Year of last update of the database or dataset
   Repository = Database name
   Accessed = Date of access (e.g. 2024-03-06 or 6 Mar 2024 or Mar 6, 2024)
   Rights = "Licence:" + CC licence (e.g. for all FAO databases, enter Licence: CC-BY-4.0)

2. When generating a bibliographic list using Zotero, it will be necessary to remove the colon from any database source that does not also include a dataset and to remove any italics from the entries. For example, the bibliographic entry created from the Zotero item in Figure A4.1 automatically included *FAOSTAT*: *Crops and livestock products* in italics. For a References section, that has been removed:
FAO. 2000. FAOSTAT: Crops and livestock products. [Accessed on 23 February 2024]. https://www.fao.org/faostat/en/#data/QCL. Licence: CC-BY-4.0.

NOTES

1 **FAO**. 2017. *Basic texts of the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations. 2017 edition, vols I & II*. Rome. [Cited 20 December 2023]. https://openknowledge.fao.org/handle/20.500.14283/mp046e

2 **IPPC Secretariat**. 2022. *International Plant Protection Convention style guide*. Rome, FAO on behalf of the Secretariat of the International Plant Protection Convention. https://openknowledge.fao.org/handle/20.500.14283/cb2433en